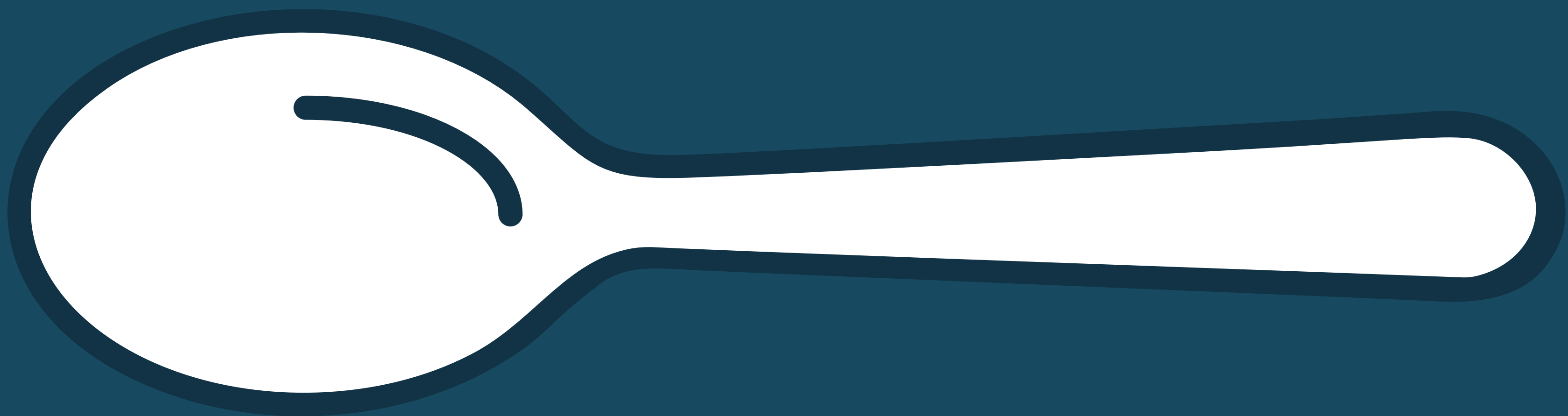




ENCRYPTING FLAVORS

FAVORITE RECIPES FROM OUR CREW



INTRO

› A collection of stories, not just recipes. ‹

This cookbook is a collection of stories — stories tied to memories, emotions, and moments that stay with us long after the meal is over.

Each dish in these pages comes from someone at Search Guard and reflects a place, a feeling, or a tradition that matters to them. Some are quick weeknight staples, others are meals connected to holidays, travels, or shared tables with friends and family. What they all have in common is that they were cooked with care, shared with others, and enjoyed more than once.

At Search Guard, we're a distributed team, spread across countries and cultures.

This book is our way of bringing those connections together: a snapshot of who we are, beyond our screens and Slack channels. Food is one of the simplest ways we connect those dots.

We hope you'll cook from it, adapt the recipes, and maybe even add a few of your own stories along the way.



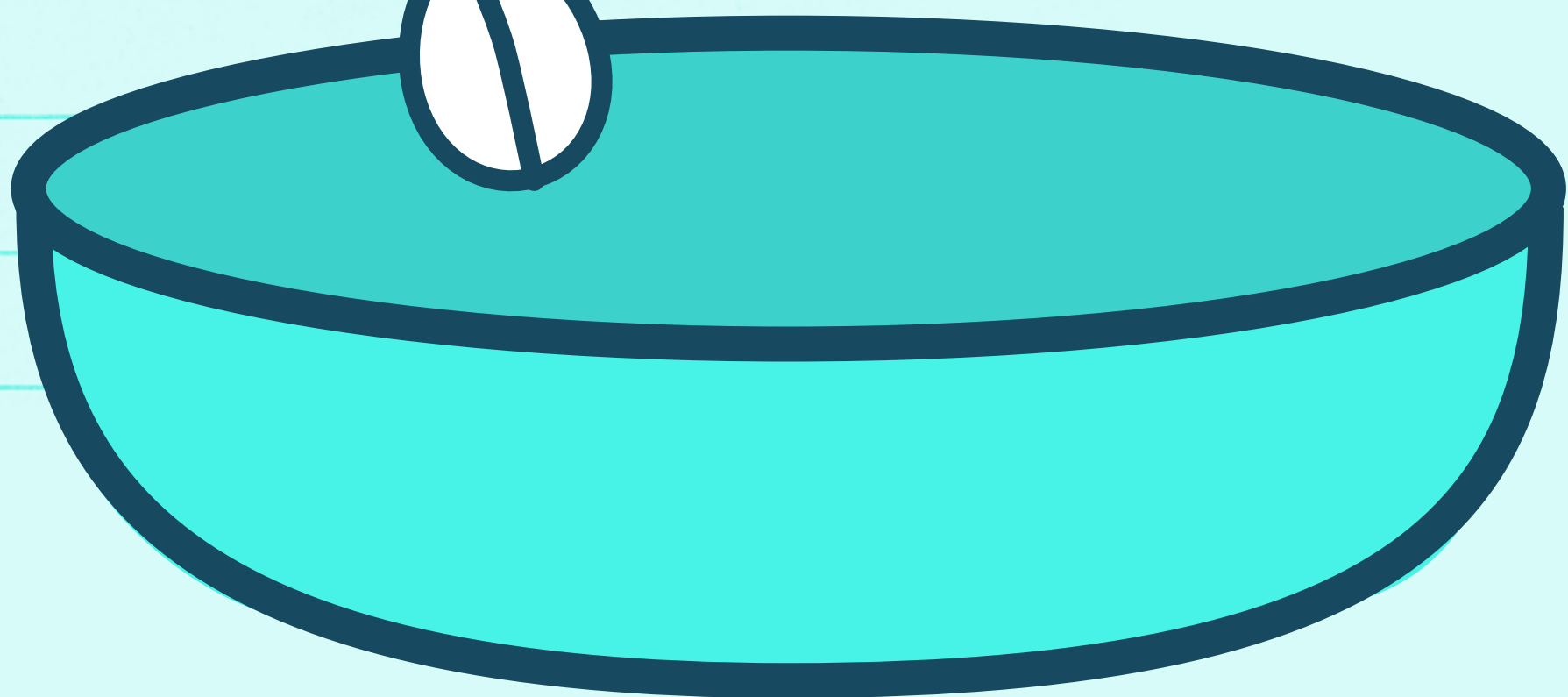
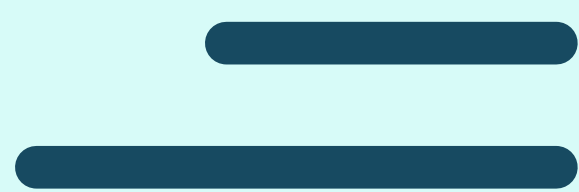
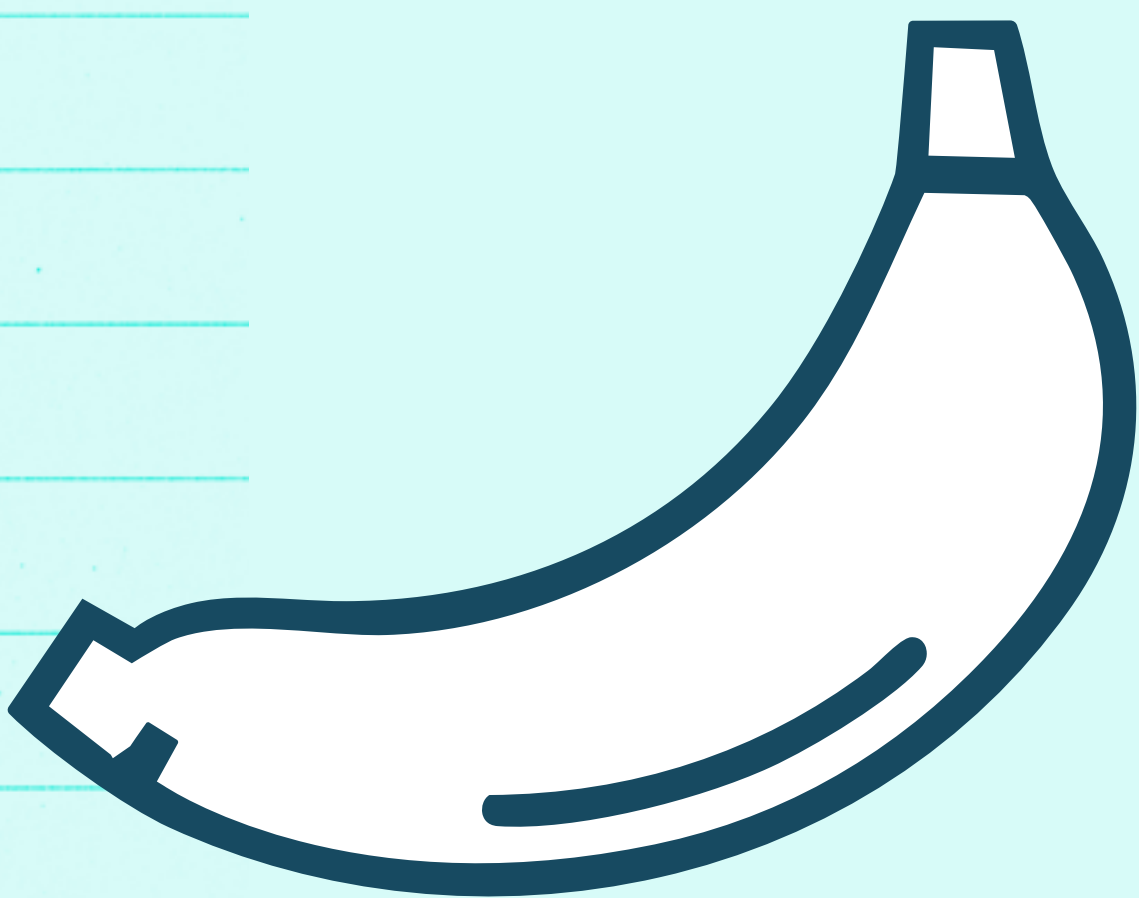
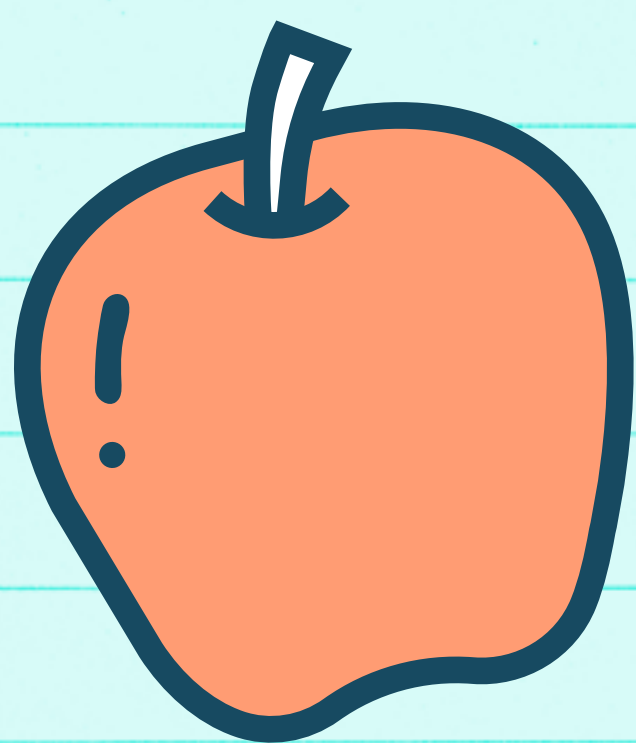
Anja

Chief Marketing Officer, Search Guard

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› This is my go-to breakfast on the mornings I go for a run. It is insanely healthy, helps you to lose weight and makes you feel full and satisfied for quite a while. ‹



HENDRIK'S RUNNING BREAKFAST

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** The night before, place the oats in a bowl and cover with water to soak overnight.
- 2** In the morning, combine the soaked oats with the quark and skyr.
- 3** Add the walnuts, hemp seeds, ground flaxseeds, and flaxseed oil.
- 4** Mix in the almond butter.
- 5** Top with the diced apple, sliced banana, chocolate chips, and any additional fruit.
- 6** Enjoy 90 min. before your run!

INGREDIENTS

30 g rolled oats
(soaked in water the night before)

a handful of walnuts

1 tbsp. hemp seeds

1 tbsp. ground flaxseeds

1 tbsp. flaxseed oil

some dark chocolate chips
(min 75% cacao)

3 tbsp. low-fat quark

2 tbsp. skyr

half a banana

1 tsp. almond butter

1 apple (finely diced)

Additional fruit as desired
(e.g., berries)

OPTIONAL

**Add a pinch of cinnamon
and/or turmeric**

› In my family, the Christmas Eve ritual has never changed—apparently, since forever: after unwrapping presents, we sit down to potato salad and frankfurters. I was told this was “poor people’s food”, the modest warm-up act before the real feasting kicks off the next day. ‹



SAXON POTATO SALAD

PREP: 15 min

COOK: 30 min

INGREDIENTS

500 g potatoes

200 g meat salad
(German-style deli meat salad)

5 pickles (gherkins)

1 onion

1 apple

1 tsp. mustard

1 tsp. salt

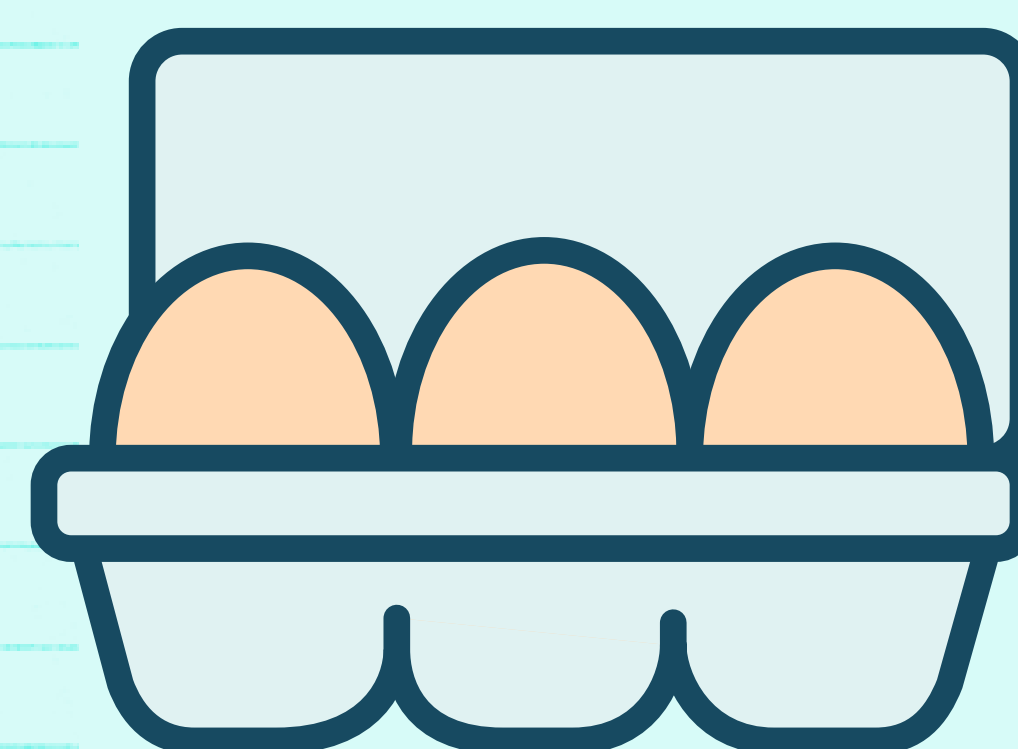
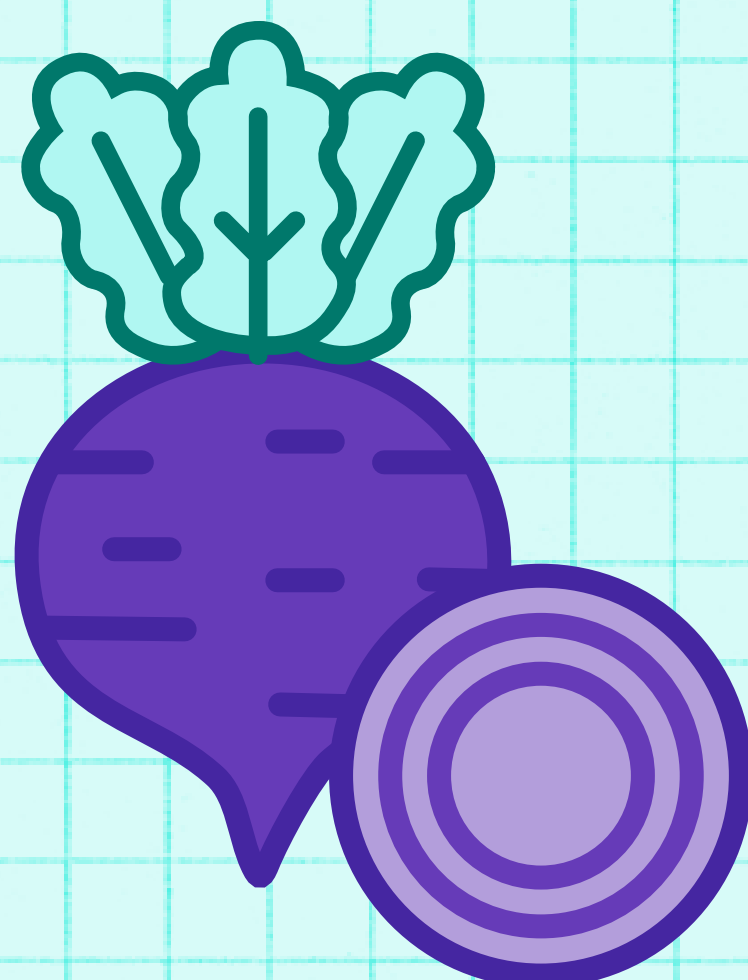
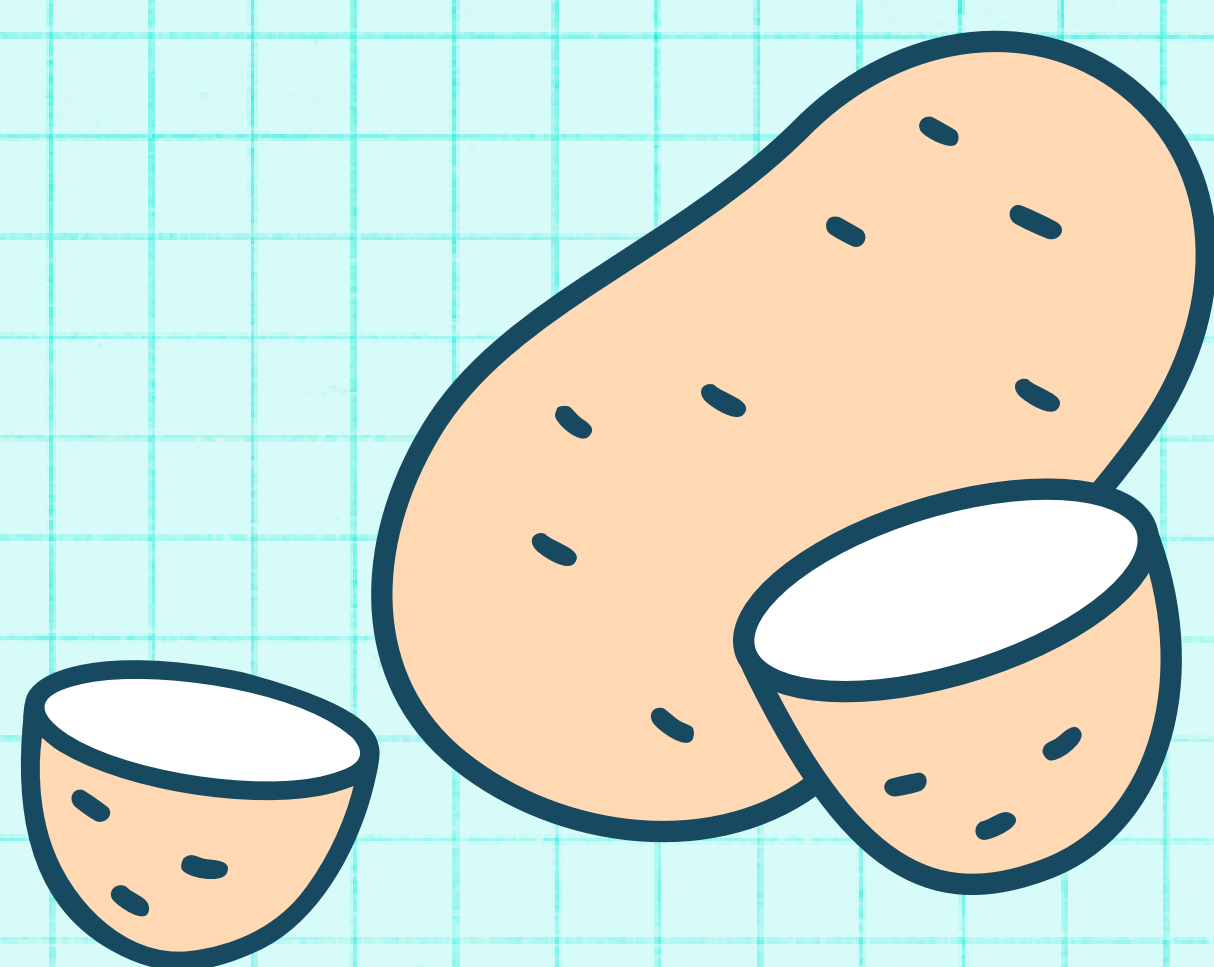
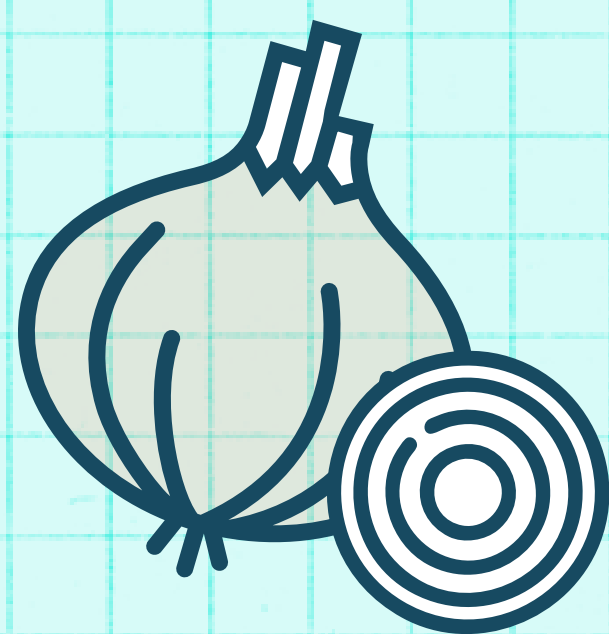
Mayonnaise
(or plain yogurt, to taste)

Pickle juice
(a little, from the pickles)

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** For the potato salad, first boil the potatoes in their skins. Then peel them and let them cool.
- 2** Cut them into small cubes and place them in a bowl. Also dice the pickles, onion, and apple into small pieces and add them to the potatoes.
- 3** Now add 1–2 tablespoons of the pickle juice, the meat salad, mustard, and salt, and carefully mix everything together into a fine salad. If the consistency still seems too dry, add a bit of yogurt or mayonnaise.
- 4** Finally, season your Saxon potato salad to taste with salt and possibly pepper, and refrigerate it again to let the flavors meld.

It's the one that I'm known for, so every family gathering, my family is always asking me to make. Shuba is the translation „fur coat“. The name comes from the concept of having many layers, which is how this dish is made.



SHUBA SALAD

PREP: 20 min

COOK: 30 min

INGREDIENTS

5 eggs

400 g marinated herring

3 large white potatoes

5-6 cooked beetroots

1 whole onion

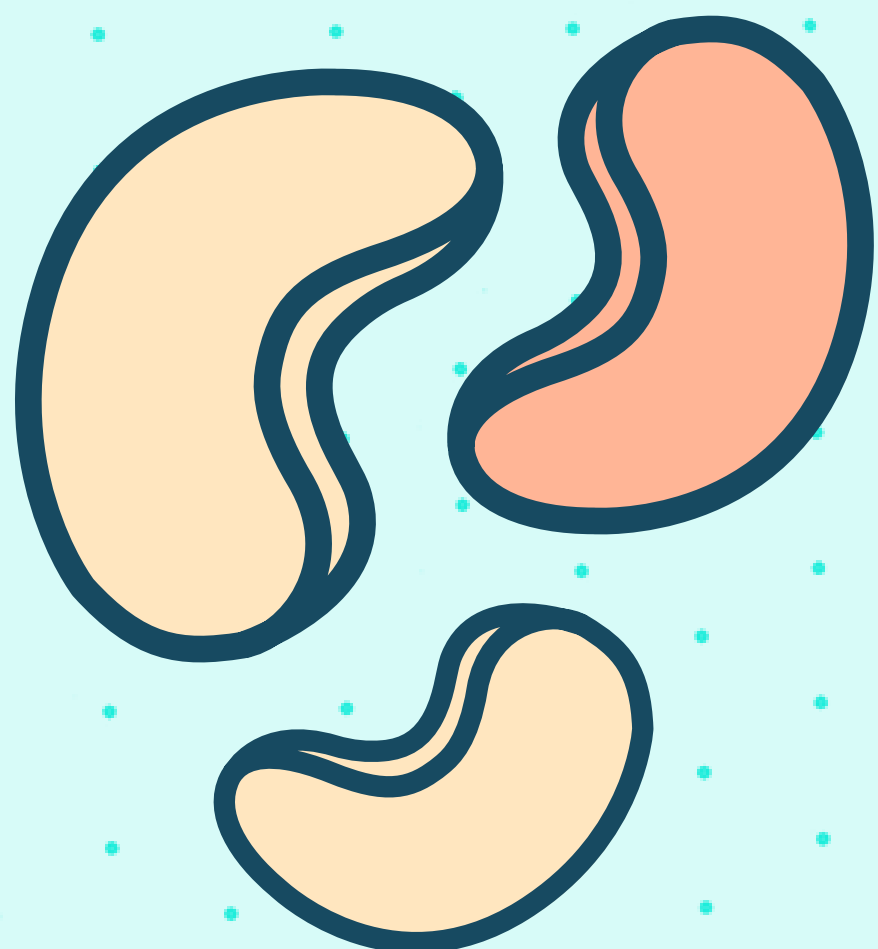
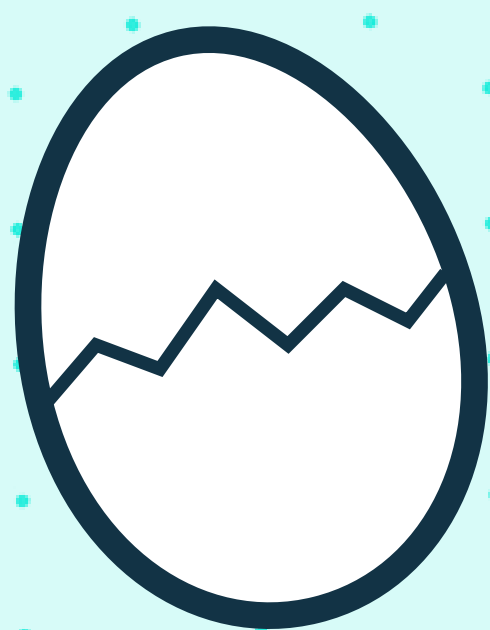
Mayonnaise

Green apple (optional)

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Start with peeling and boiling the potatoes and boiling the eggs.
- 2** Once the potatoes are ready, take them out and using a fork mash them on plate to create the base.
- 3** Put a thin layer of mayonnaise on top.
- 4** Slice up the herrings and place as the next layer.
- 5** Dice the onion and put on top of the herring.
- 6** Peel the eggs and separate the yolk from the whites in 2 separate containers. Grade the whites and place them on top of the onion.
- 7** Grate the beetroot and place on top as the next layer.
- 8** Add another layer of mayonnaise.
- 9** Mush up the end yolks and place on top of the beetroot.
- 10** (Optional) If you are feeling extra cheeky, grate (finely) a 3rd of a green apple and sprinkle on top for extra crunch and freshness.

› A specialty from the Southern United States ‹



SPICY COCKTAIL NUTS

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Preheat oven to 120°C. Use a large baking sheet or two smaller ones.
- 2** Mix egg white with water until foamy. Add nuts and spice mix until evenly coated.
- 3** Mix nuts evenly on the baking sheet and bake for 45 min. until dry but not too dark. Stir every quarter hour. Allow all sides to cool down.
- 4** Allow to cool on the baking sheet, then transfer to containers. After baking, they'll still be slightly sticky but will become dry during cooling.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 large egg white**
- 1 tsp. water**
- 560 g mixed nuts**
(almonds, peanuts, sunflower seeds, cashews, etc.)
- 2 EL tbsp. Creole spice mix**
(recipe below)
- ½ tsp. cayenne pepper**
- ¼ tsp. salt**
- 100 g sugar**

CREOLE SPICE MIX

- 1 tbsp. paprika**
- 1 tbsp. salt**
- 1 tbsp. garlic powder**
- ½ tbsp. ground black pepper**
- ½ tbsp. onion powder**
- ½ tbsp. cayenne pepper**
- ½ tbsp. dried oregano**
- ½ tbsp. dried thyme**

› German Beer Spread from Bavaria ‹



OBATZDA

PREP: 15 min

SERVINGS: 4

INGREDIENTS

250 g ripe Camembert cheese

80 g cream cheese

1 small onion, finely diced

1 tsp. sweet paprika powder

some freshly ground pepper

about 2 tbsp. beer

(more or less depending on the consistency you like)

1 tsp. cumin

(ground if you don't like the seeds)

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Cut the Camembert into cubes and mash it with a fork.
- 2** Fold in the cream cheese.
- 3** Mix in the beer and stir the mixture until creamy.
- 4** Add the onion, pepper, paprika powder, and cumin.

RECIPE TIPS

If you serve it as a dip, use less beer than if you serve it as a spread.

Serve it with soft pretzels or pretzel chips.

› I think I just saw the recipe on Instagram one day and decided to try it myself. Changed a few things over the years and that's the outcome! I often get asked to cook it for parties and I was told that apparently, this rice can also help when suffering from a hangover. ‹



EGG FRIED RICE

INSTRUCTIONS

First of all, the quantity of the ingredients is only a rough estimation (I usually freestyle this and use whatever I have in my fridge). You can also use other ingredients if you want, the foundation of this dish is already in its name: Egg and Rice. Everything else is up to you!

- 1** Cut everything in bite-sized pieces. For the spring onion, you want to separate the green and the white parts and cut it in small pieces. The green part of the spring onion will be added right at the end.
- 2** Add some oil to a frying pan (or a wok if you have it) and cook the chicken on medium high heat for a few min. until it is thoroughly cooked. Place to the side.
- 3** Crack the eggs into a bowl, stir until the egg yolk and the egg whites are mixed. Add the mixture to the pan and cook the eggs on medium-low heat. You want to have scrambled eggs at the end, so don't forget to stir. Right before the eggs are ready, add a little soy sauce and stir. Place to the side.

PREP: 20 min

COOK: 15 min

SERVINGS: 3-4

INGREDIENTS

Cooked Rice (leftover from the day before if possible)

3-4 eggs

1 red pepper

2 spring onions

3-4 ginger (or ginger paste, saves you a lot of work)

2 shallots
(or 1-2 normal onions)

2-3 cloves of garlic

500 g chicken
(breast or thigh, up to you)

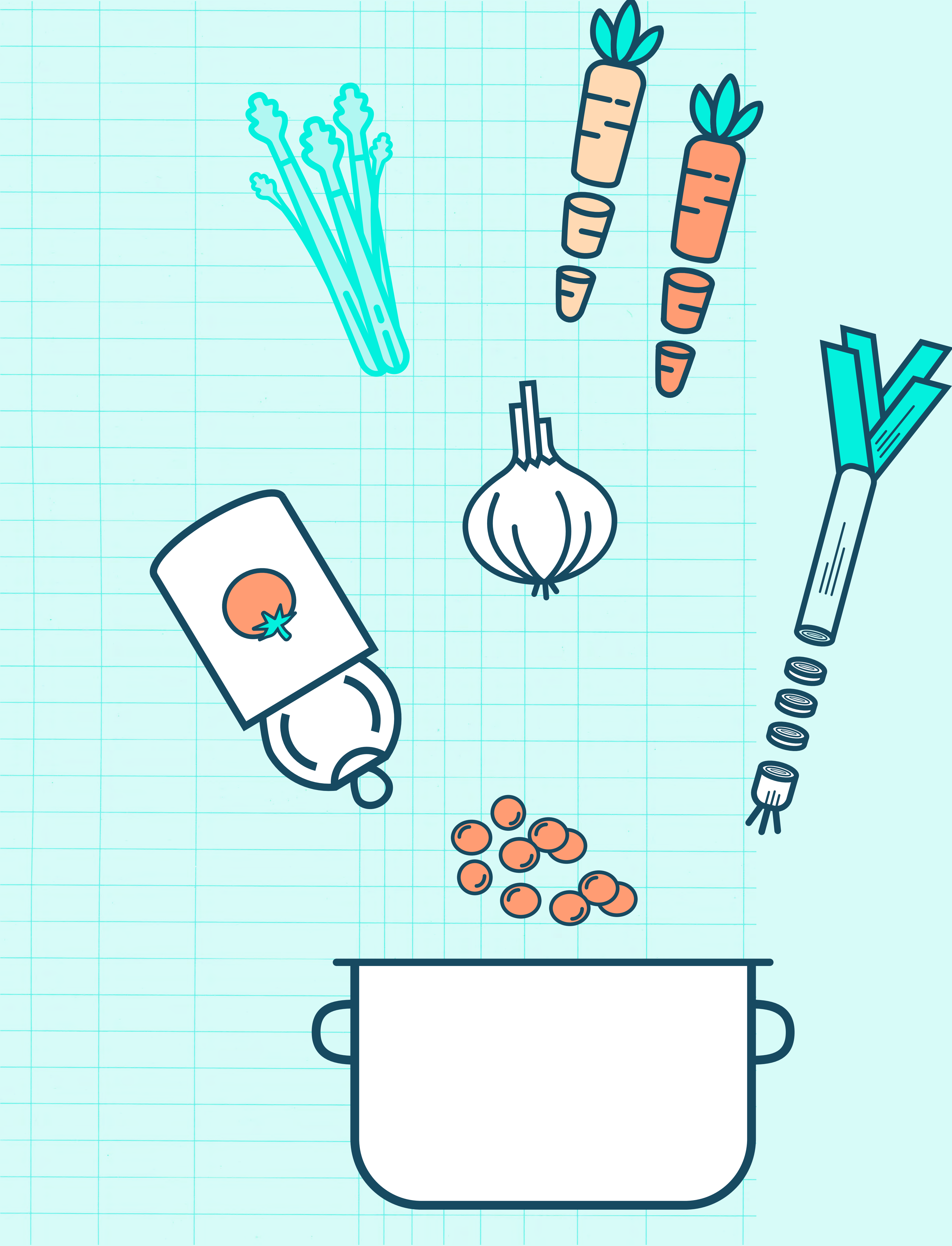
Peas (like a cup or so)

1 tsp. of sambal oelek

(dark) soy sauce
(or fish sauce, whatever you like more)

oil (sesame if possible, but any vegetable oil will do)

- 4** Add the shallots, white parts of the spring onion, garlic and ginger to the pan and reduce the heat to medium. Cook for a few min., then add the pepper and the peas and stir. After a few more min., place to the side.
- 5** Again, add a little bit of oil and the (leftover) rice to the pan and cook on medium-high/high heat. It is important to stir continuously, otherwise the rice will burn and stick to the pan.
- 6** After a few min., add some sambal oelek to the rice and stir until it is spread evenly (if you never had sambal before, be aware that it is pretty spicy and one tea spoon might even be too hot for some people).
- 7** After that, add some soy sauce to the rice and continue stirring. You will see that the rice will start to get a little brown (if it did not already).
- 8** Reduce the heat to medium, add everything you placed aside to warm it up a bit and mix thoroughly. Taste for salt and pepper, maybe add a bit of sambal if it is not spicy enough. Garnish with the green parts of the spring onion and **enjoy!**



VEGETARIAN LENTIL BOLOGNESE

INSTRUCTIONS

This dish is a vegetarian alternative to classic Bolognese sauce and tastes best with tagliatelle or spaghetti. If you omit the butter and milk or use margarine and oat milk instead, it can even be made completely vegan.

1 Finely chop the onion, carrots, celery, and leek. Heat olive oil and a piece of butter in a wide pan or large pot—a wok also does wonderful service here. Sauté the onion, carrots, celery, and leek with a pinch of sugar over medium heat until the onions are translucent. Then stir in a tablespoon of tomato paste and briefly sauté together.

2 Increase the heat and deglaze everything with a robust red wine. Depending on taste, you can use more or less wine, but it should be at least 250 to 350 ml.

Continue simmering over medium heat until the alcohol has evaporated. Pour the rest of the wine into the cook.

Depending on the amount consumed, the following steps can then be designed as creatively as desired.

PREP: 20 min

COOK: 40 min

INGREDIENTS

Olive oil

1 large onion

2 large carrots

2 stalks celery

Some celery root (optional)

¼ stalk leek

Pinch of sugar

1 tbsp. tomato paste

250 ml red wine

1 can diced tomatoes

150 ml passata

200 g red lentils

Salt, pepper

Vegetable broth/stock

Oregano

Milk

Parmesan or Pecorino cheese

3 Add a can of diced tomatoes and 150 ml of passata. TIP: If you don't have passata at home, you can instead process a few tomatoes with a kitchen blender until the consistency is roughly the same.

The whole thing now needs to simmer for a long time over low heat with the lid closed. The longer it simmers, the more flavor—unfortunately anything under an hour won't do. In the meantime, you can wash the lentils. Depending on taste, you can use more or fewer lentils here too, but 200 g is a safe bet.

4 Now set to medium heat and add the lentils. Cook the sauce until the lentils are al dente, but not too soft or mushy. At the same time, put the pasta water on and cook the pasta. When the pasta is al dente, drain it and save some pasta water.

5 After about 15–20 min, the lentils should be ready. Now add a splash of milk and season everything with salt, pepper, vegetable broth, and oregano. If the sauce is too liquid, simply reduce it a bit more. If it's too thick, add some of the reserved pasta water. Fold the pasta into the sauce and briefly cook together again. Serve on a plate and sprinkle with Parmesan or Pecorino to taste.

› In the 1990s, my mom lovingly typed up our most popular old family recipes on the PC with meticulous care and created a cookbook of over a hundred pages, which she gave as gifts to her children, nieces, nephews, and now also grandchildren. From it, I selected the leek-onion tart, which my mom often baked for the buffet at our large family celebrations in Ravensburg. I continued the tradition in Berlin and baked the leek-onion tart for various student parties in our Kreuzberg shared apartment. Meanwhile, we've also baked it for numerous buffets at our daughter's school events and have passed the recipe on again and again to friends.

The leek-onion tart is not particularly complicated, it just needs some time because of the yeast dough, and since it's very hearty and savory, even non-vegetarians enjoy it :-)

P.S. Instead of butter, we now use olive oil. ›



LEEK-ONION TART

PREP: 90 min

BAKE: 45 min

INGREDIENTS

DOUGH (rectangular baking sheet)

- 30 g yeast
- 300 g butter, sour creme or yogurt
- 350 g wheat flour
- 150 g rye flour
- 2 tsp. each: cumin, coriander
- 50 g butter
- 1 tsp. salt
- 50 g grated cheese

TOPPING

- 300 g onions
- 300 g leeks
- 60 g butter
- 4 tbsp. water
- 2 vegetable bouillon cubes
- 2 tsp. marjoram
- 3 tsp. thyme
- Black pepper
- 200 g grated Emmentaler cheese

CUSTARD

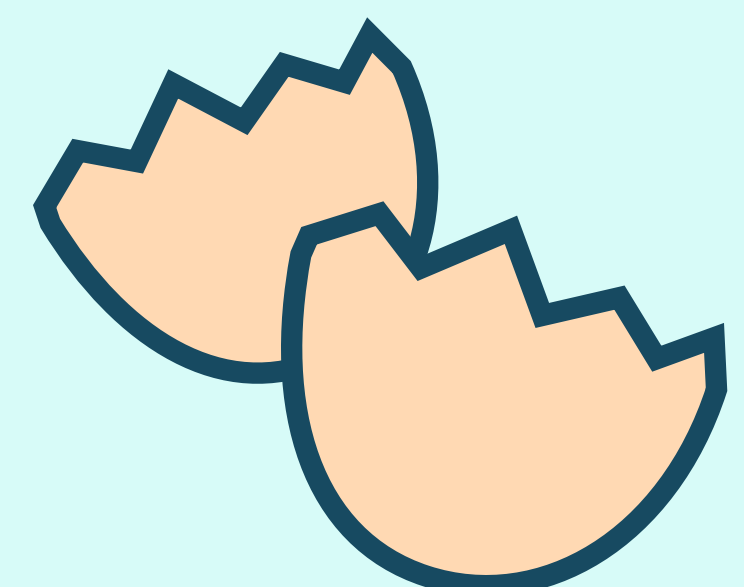
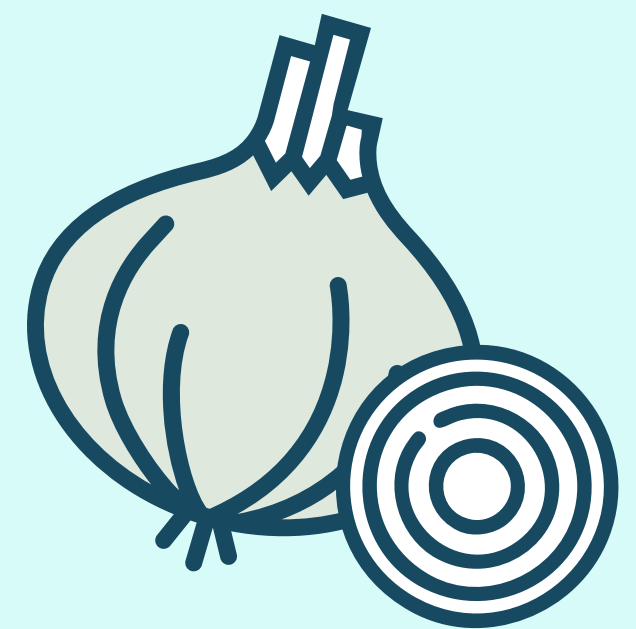
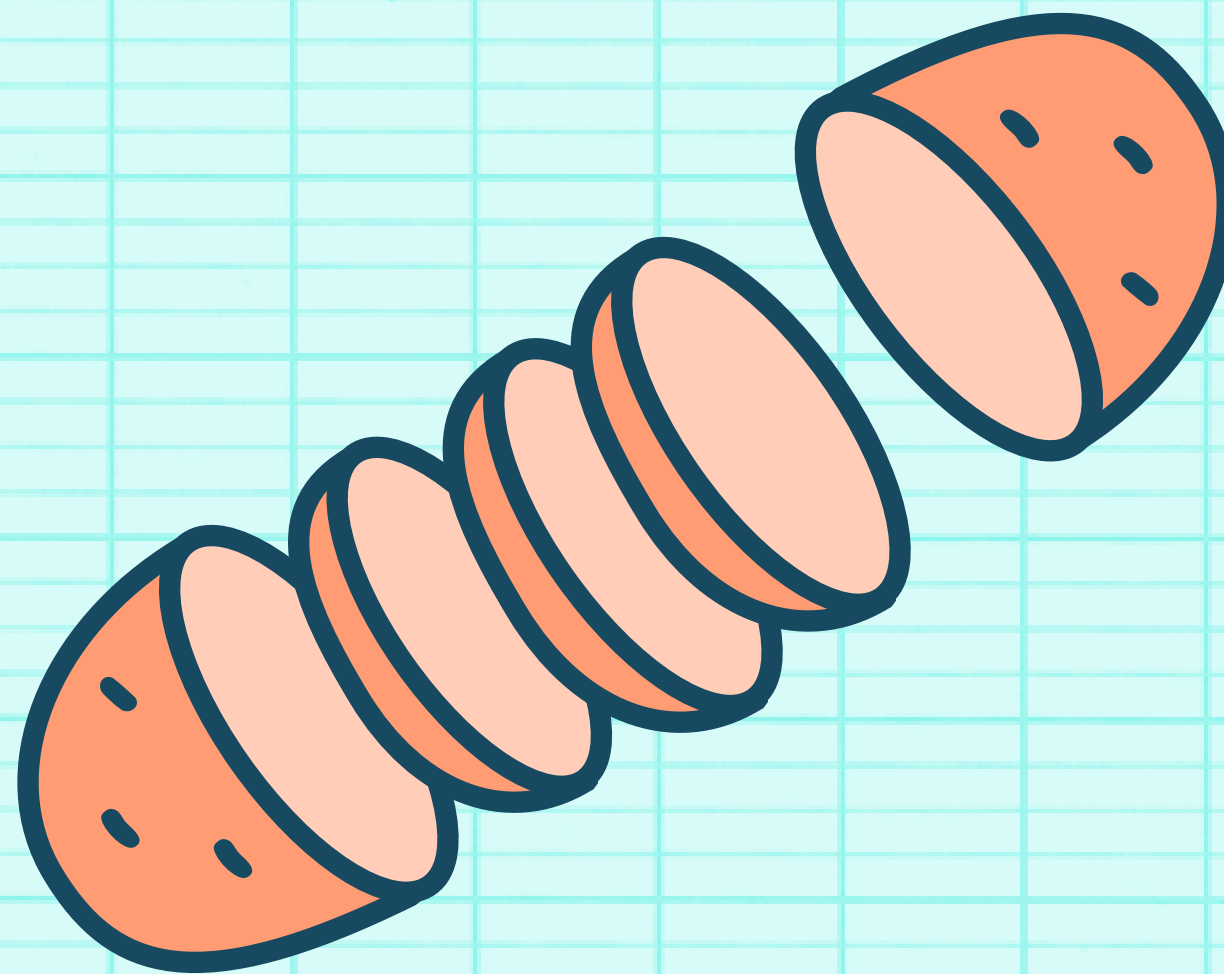
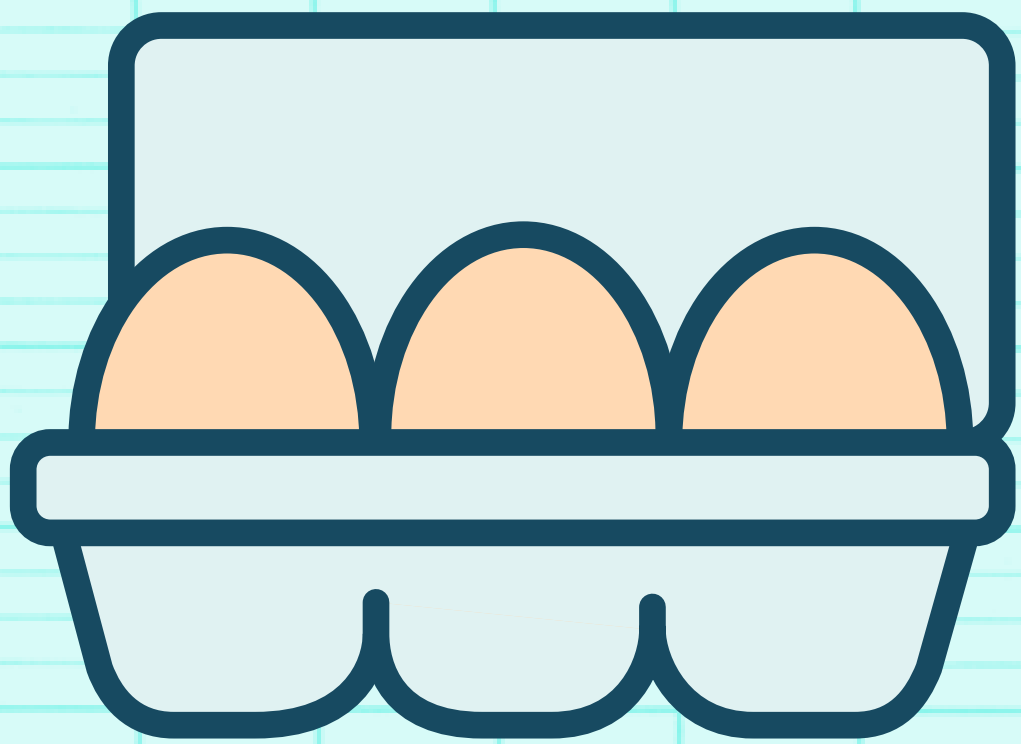
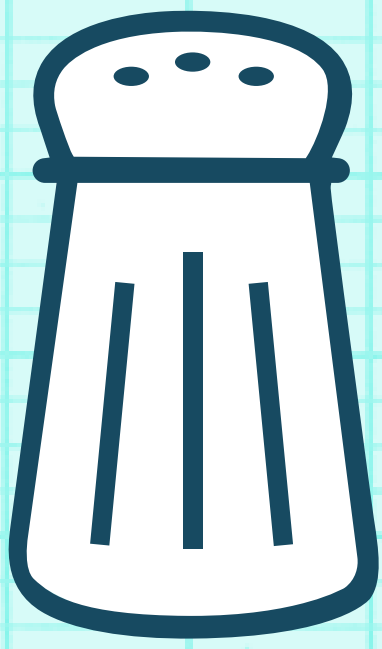
- 4 eggs
- 200g crème fraîche
- ½ tsp. herb salt
- 150 g peanuts roasted, salted

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1 Prepare and allow yeast dough to rise.
- 2 Cut onions and leeks into thin strips and sauté for about 10 min., season well and let cool slightly.
- 3 Roll out dough on baking sheet, spread with half of the cheese, then add vegetable mixture on top, then distribute remaining cheese.
- 4 Pour the custard mixture over and top with peanuts.
- 5 Bake for about 40-45 min. at 180°C.

Freezes very well.

› I'm doing a volunteer year in Spain and living with a Spanish host family with five young children. My host family showed me how to make tortilla. Because they make it often and I really like it, I wanted to learn how to do it. Now I can make it for my family and friends back in Berlin. The little children diligently peeled potatoes, and we thoroughly enjoyed the tortilla we made.
¡Que aproveche! ›



TORTILLAS

PREP: 20 min

COOK: 15 min

SERVINGS: 4

INGREDIENTS

1 onion

5 big potatoes

(more or less depending on whether you prefer it more solid or not)

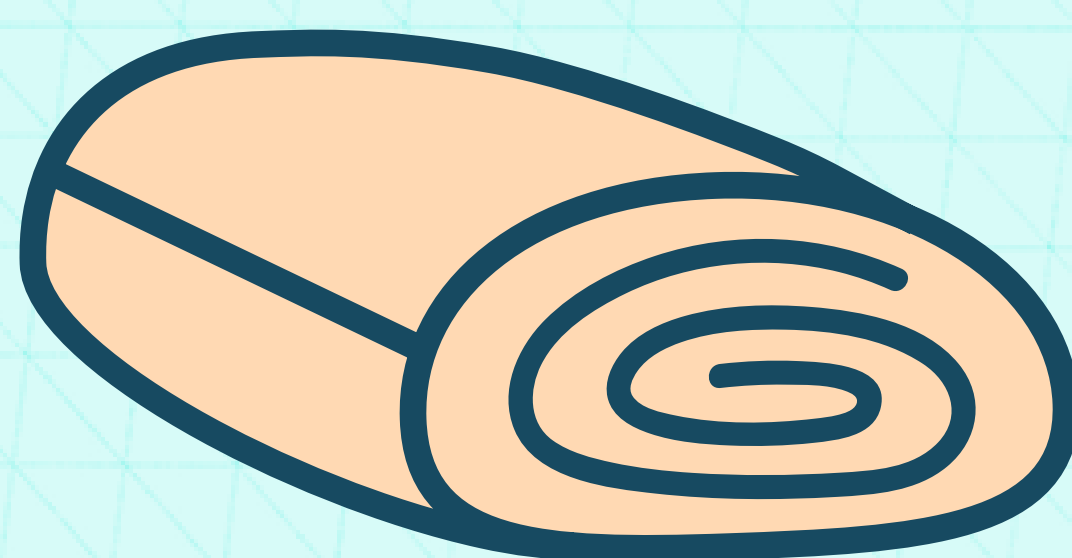
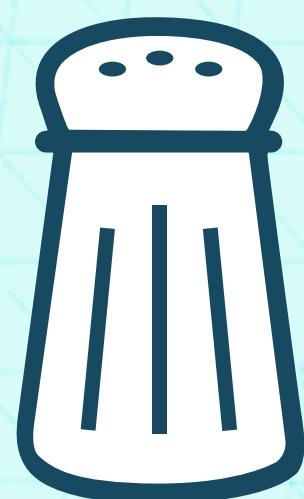
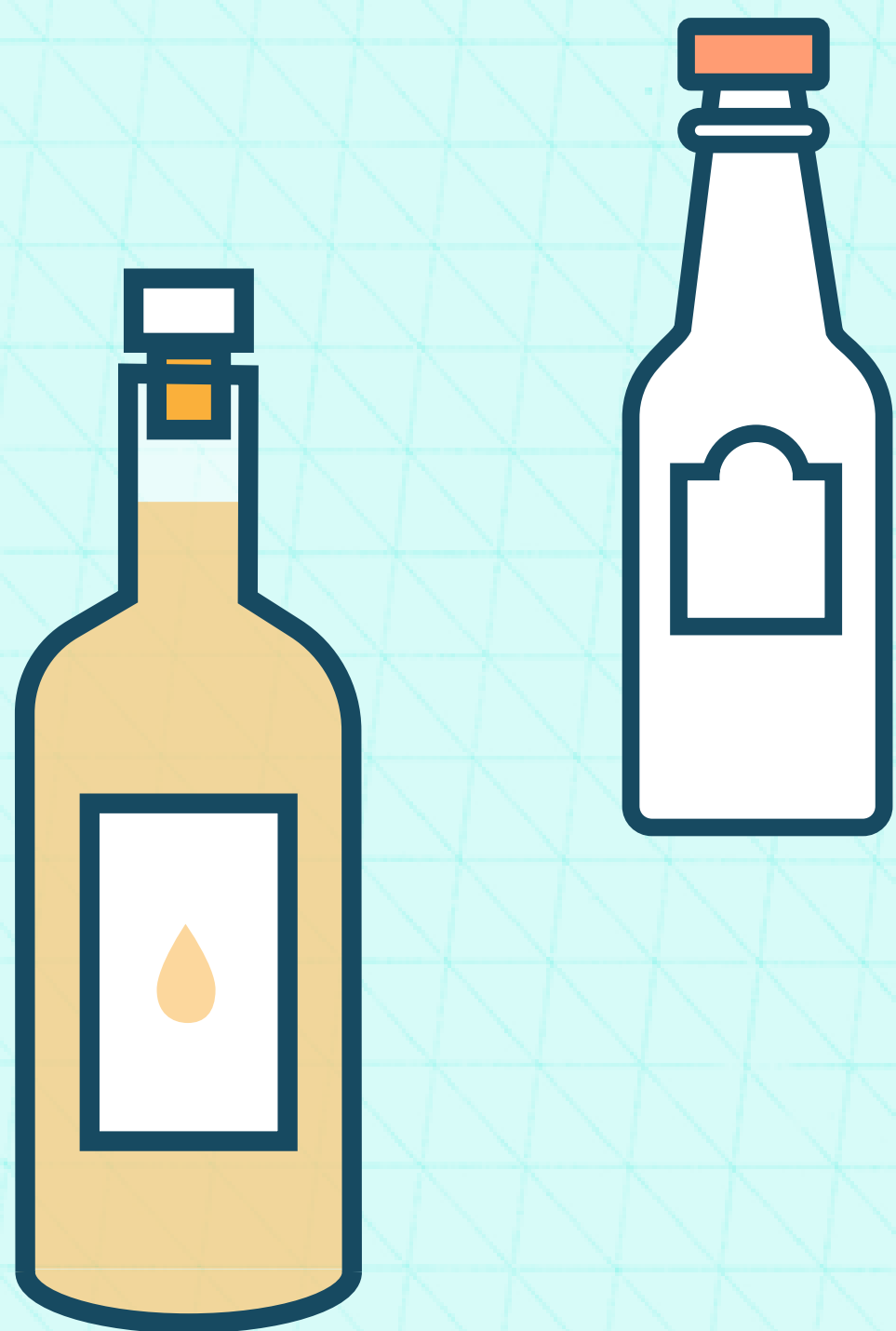
8 eggs

salt

oil

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Finely chop the onions and sauté them in oil, but don't let them brown.
- 2** Peel and chop the potatoes.
- 3** Add the potatoes to the onions, season with salt, and make sure they don't get brown either.
- 4** Fry until the potatoes are tender.
- 5** Crack the eggs into a bowl, mix with salt and whisk until frothy.
- 6** Add the potatoes and onions to the eggs.
- 7** Pour the mixture into a small pan (do not stir!).
- 8** When the mixture has set on one side, place a plate on the pan upside down, then flip the pan over to turn the mixture onto the plate and slide it back into the pan with the liquid side down.
- 9** Serve on plate.



» When I was little I loved my mothers apfelstrudel! But it was a real drama to bring her to produce one so it was always a special occasion :)

a) She said it needs to be made from very fresh eggs – ideally right out of the hen into the bowl...

b) She found it to be too much work

One day I found the following recipe and from that day on i just did it myself whenever i felt like it, it requires no eggs and nothing fancy (just vinegar oil salt water and flour) and you can even use other stuffings like bolognese or spinach and cheese or nuts and honey... anything really just as the title says it has become my signature dish. «

STRUDEL DOUGH FOR ALL TYPES OF FILLINGS

INSTRUCTIONS

PREP: 30 min

BAKE: 50 min

INGREDIENTS

300 g (about 2 ½ cups) **flour**
(all-purpose)

5 tbsp. oil (sunflower or neutral
vegetable oil)

½ tsp. salt

1 tbsp. vinegar (white wine or
apple cider vinegar)

about ¼ l hot water (1 cup)

**a little flour for dusting the
work surface**

some oil for greasing the dough

some melted butter for brushing

1 Sift the flour onto your work surface and make a well in the center.

Pour 5 tablespoons of oil into a measuring cup, add ½ teaspoon of salt, 1 tablespoon of vinegar, and fill up to ¼ liter (250 ml) with hot water.

2 Pour the liquid into the flour. From the center outward, mix the flour into a smooth dough. Start stirring gently, then knead with floured hands.

3 Beat the dough 50 to 70 times on the floured surface until it's shiny and elastic. Shape it into a ball, rub it with oil, and let it rest for 1 hour under a bowl.

4 Lay a linen cloth on a table that you can reach from all sides. Roll out the dough on it with a rolling pin into a thin rectangle.

5 To stretch the dough, lift it up and place it over the backs of your hands, gently pulling it outward. Work from the center to the edges. Cut off any thick edges.

6 Brush the dough with melted butter to make it more pliable.

Place your filling along one-third of the long side. Roll the strudel by lifting the cloth, folding in the edges to seal the sides.

Roll out the dough on it with a rolling pin into a thin rectangle.

7 Lift the strudel (still on the cloth) and place it on a greased baking tray, seam side down. Curve it into a U-shape if necessary. Brush with butter and bake at 200 °C (Gas Mark 3 / 390 °F) for 40–50 min, brushing several times with butter during baking so that the crust turns flaky.

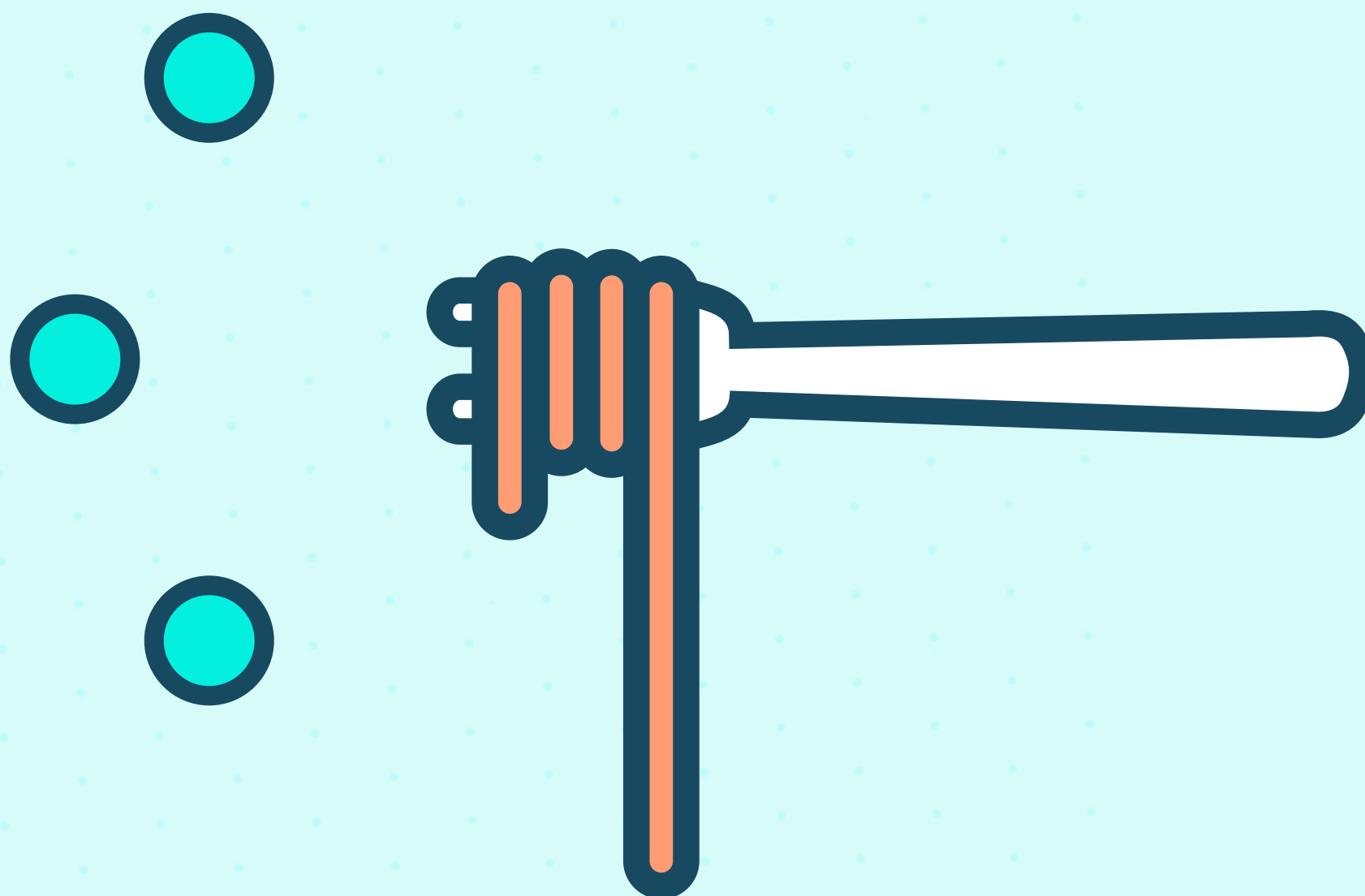
Strudel is a traditional dish in southern Germany and Austria.

The dough is the most important part. It should wrap the juicy fillings, prevent them from drying out, and keep the aromas from escaping.

The dough should be so thin that you can clearly see the pattern underneath it.

Don't worry—it's easier than it sounds!

› I was invited to a ceramic painting event with friends about a year ago and since my creativity was low that day I decided to paint the Search Guard logo on a sauce boat. After that I looked up what recipes I could cook that could make use of that sauce boat. And there it was. Pasta with salmon sauce. This recipe also reminded me of the good old days when I had my first internship at floragunn (I was still in school back then). During that time Jochen once made salmon pasta for dinner it was delicious! ›



MICKY'S SALMON PASTA

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Coarsely grate the lemon zest and squeeze the juice. Cut the salmon into pieces.
- 2** Briefly sear the salmon in oil, season with salt and pepper, and remove from the pan. Add the cream and vegetable stock to the pan and reduce slightly. Add half of the lemon zest, bring to the boil, stir in the sauce thickener or reduce further.
- 3** Season with lemon juice, salt, pepper, and a small amount of herbes de Provence (do not use too many herbs!). Place the fish in the sauce, heat through, but do not allow to boil!
- 4** In the meantime, cook the pasta in salted water according to the instructions, add the peas for the last 2 min, then drain and carefully mix with the salmon and sauce. Garnish with dill and lemon wedges.

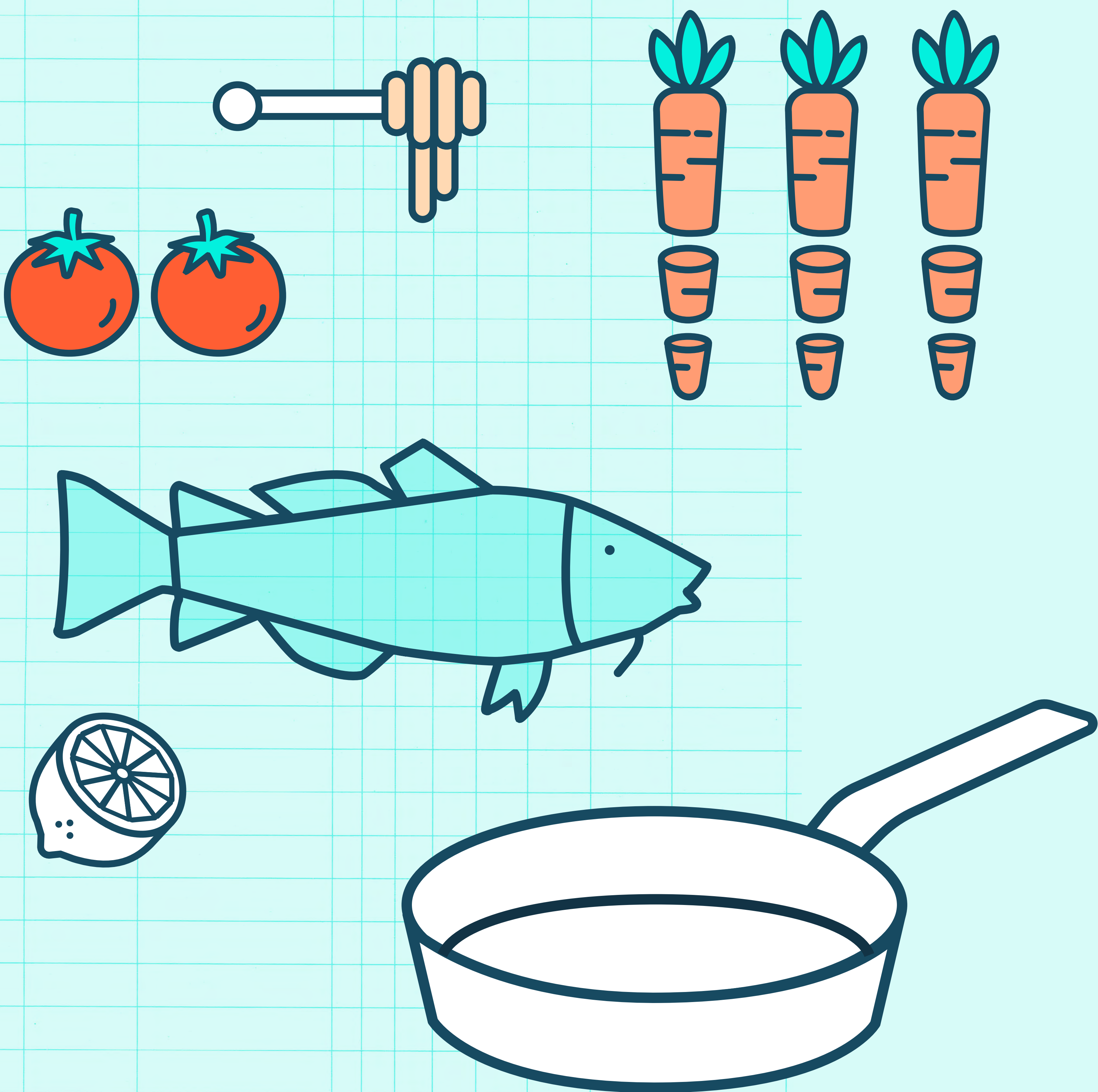
PREP: 20 min

SERVINGS: 3

INGREDIENTS

- 300 g Tagliatelle
- 250 g Salmon fillet(s)
- 200 g Frozen Peas
- Water (Salt water)
- 1 Lemon untreated
- 2 tbsp. oil
- Salt and white pepper
- 250 ml vegetable broth
- 200 g cream
- 1 pinch herbes de Provence
- Sauce thickener (if necessary)
- some dill for garnish
- lemon(s)-wedges for garnish

› In our house we don't use recipes;
we just make food "off the top of our heads". ‹



COD WITH VEGETABLES

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Preheat the oven to 170° C.
- 2** In a skillet heat 2 tablespoons oil.
- 3** Peel the onion and cut into slices and add in a skillet on 5 min..
- 4** Peel the celery root, carrots, parsley root and rub on a grater, add to onions in a skillet, on 5 min..
- 5** Place in a skillet pimento herbal, bay leaf, tomatoes in half, salt and pepper, passata, lemon juice and honey. Combine all ingredients in a skillet.
- 6** Put all ingredients in the ovenproof dish.
- 7** Cut the cod into 5 cm slices. Put the cod fillets on top and garnish with salt and pepper.
- 8** Bake in the oven for 17 min. at 170°C.

PREP: 30 min

BAKE: 17 min

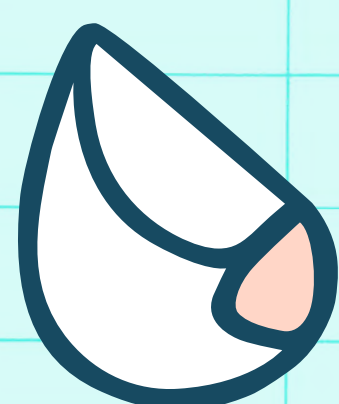
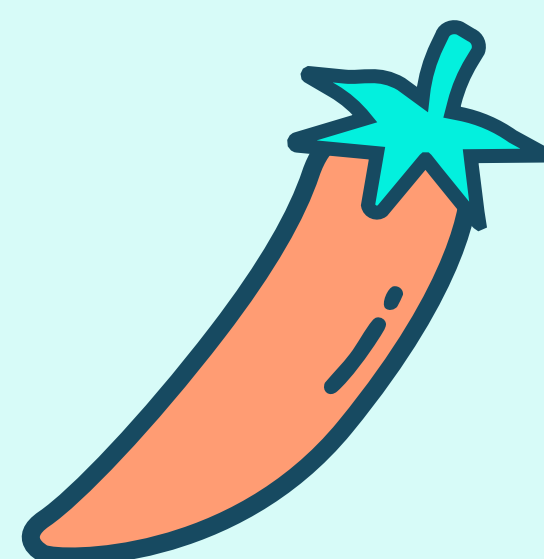
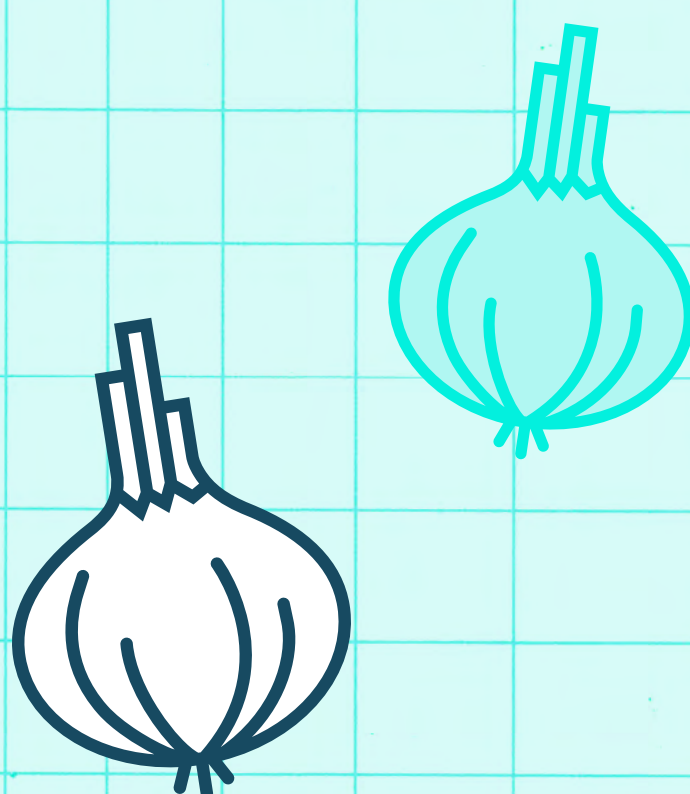
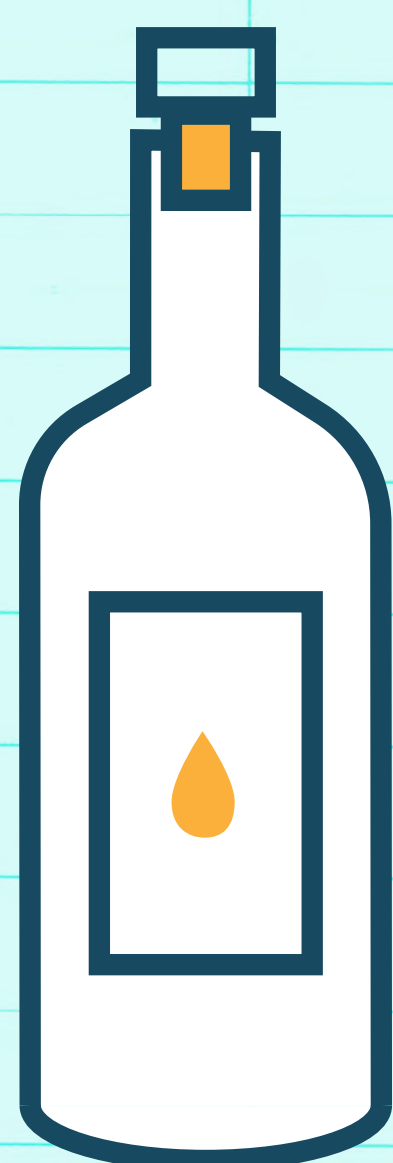
SERVINGS: 2

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cod fillets
- 1 onion
- 3 carrots
- 1 parsley root
- ¼ celery root
- 5 pimento herbs
- 2 bay leaf
- 2 tomatoes
- salt and pepper
- tbsp. olive oil
- 2 tbsp. tomato passata
- tbsp. lemon juice
- tbsp. honey

That is one of my favorites dishes from Laotian/Thai cuisine. Jeow Mak Len is the sauce.

Short story: This dish made my (now) fiancée to become my girlfriend originally. And as a Polish man I can compare it to a Polish dish called Goląbki, at least it reminds me of it.



PORK LARB

THE NATIONAL DISH OF LAOS

PREP: 5 min

COOK: 20 min

SERVINGS: 4

INGREDIENTS

1 tbsp. uncooked sticky rice
(you can also substitute regular white rice if you don't have sticky rice)

1 tbsp. vegetable oil

1 pound ground pork (450g)

¼ tsp. sugar

1 tbsp. fish sauce

1 lime (juiced)

1 red chili (sliced)

3 shallots
(peeled and thinly sliced)

3 scallions (chopped)

¼ cup cilantro

½ cup mint

INSTRUCTIONS

Pork Larb is a Southeast Asian meat salad from Laos that only takes min. to make. If you've never had this quick and easy pork larb, you HAVE to try it!

- 1** In a dry wok or pan over low heat, toast the rice grains, stirring continuously until they turn golden and fragrant—about 10 min. Grind to a coarse powder in a mortar & pestle. Set aside.
- 2** Place your wok back over high heat until smoking. Add the oil and the ground pork. Stir-fry until the pork is browned, and add in the toasted rice powder, sugar, fish sauce, and lime juice.
- 3** Stir-fry for another minute, and then add in the chili, shallots, scallions, cilantro, and mint. Stir-fry for one more minute, and then taste for seasoning, adding more chili, sugar, fish sauce, and/or lime juice to your taste if needed.
- 4** Serve with sticky rice, steamed jasmine rice, and/or lettuce leaves.

JEOW MAK LEN

LAO TOMATO DIPPING SAUCE

INGREDIENTS

25 cherry tomatoes

2 large shallots

1 head of garlic

15 fresh bird's eye chili peppers

1 pinch glutamate

1 tbsp. padaek

2 tbsp. fish sauce

1 handful cilantro, diced

INSTRUCTIONS

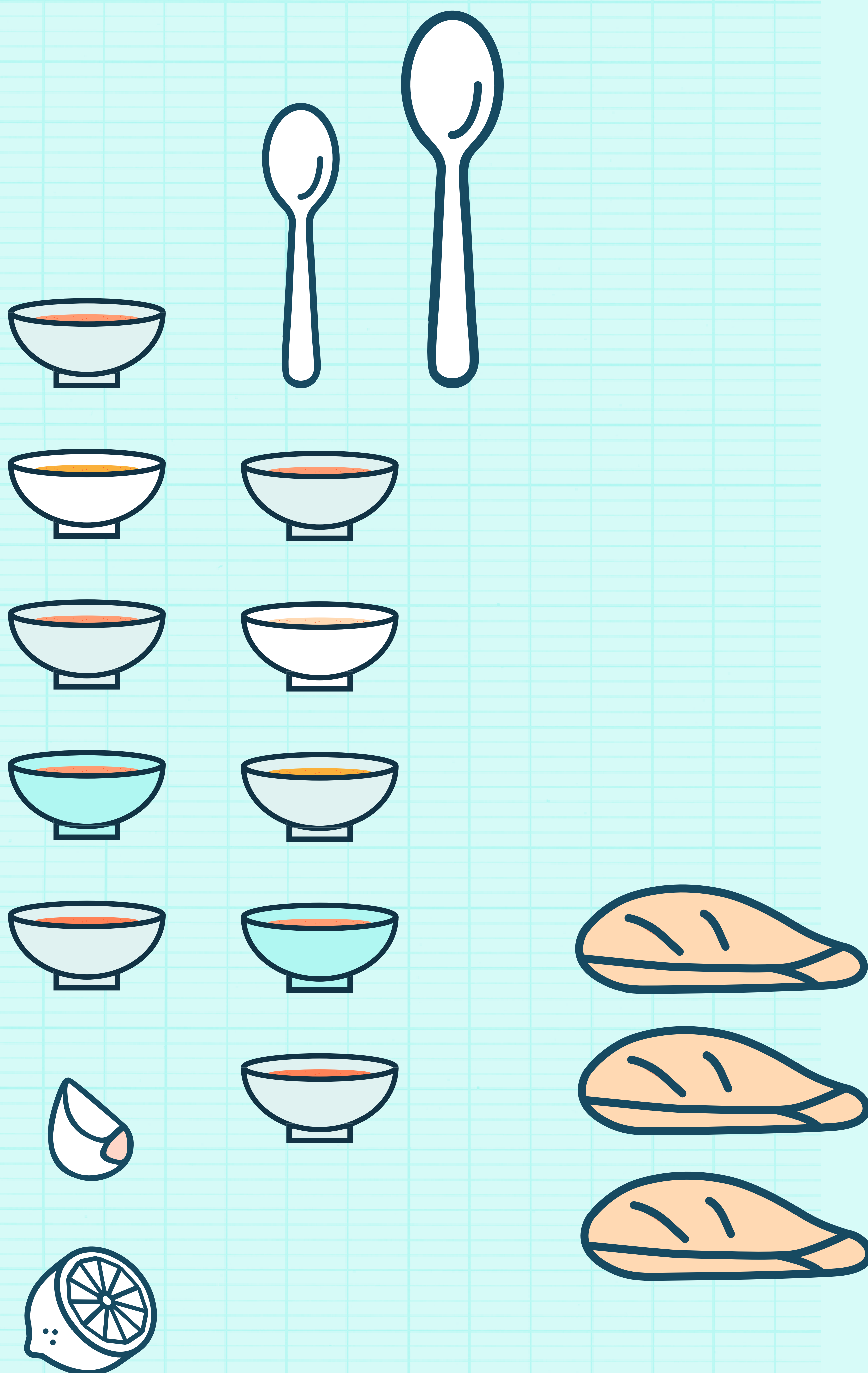
Jeow mak len is a classic Lao tomato dipping sauce that's rich, smoky, and perfect with sticky rice or grilled meats. Roasting the ingredients in the air fryer intensifies the flavor, making this spicy tomato dip a must-try for your next BBQ.

1 In an air-fryer tray, add the tomatoes, shallots, garlic, and peppers. Put it in the air-fryer at 200 °C for 20 min. You can use a regular oven as well.

2 With a mortar and pestle, add the garlic and peppers and smash into a paste. Add the shallots and smash and mix well with the paste. Finally, add the tomatoes and carefully smash.

3 Season the dip with glutamate, padaek, and fish sauce. Mix well. Season to taste.

4 Lastly, add a handful of cilantro and mix well.



TANDOORI CHICKEN

INSTRUCTIONS

1 Prepare the Chicken:

Slice the chicken breast or thigh into thin strips for even and faster cooking.

2 Make the Marinade:

In a mixing bowl, add sarson ka tel and Kashmiri lal mirch, mix well till the oil takes on a rich red color. Add the rest of the masalas and ingredients. Mix well to form a smooth marinade.

3 Marinate the Chicken:

Coat the chicken pieces well and keep aside for at least 1–2h (longer marination = juicier flavor). Do not marinate beyond 20h in the fridge, or it may spoil.

4 Smoking (Dhungar):

Place a small katori (bowl) in the marinated chicken, drop in a piece of hot charcoal, drizzle ghee on it, and cover immediately for 4–5 min. For mild smokiness, smoke at marination stage. For medium smokiness, smoke after grilling. For bold smoky flavor, smoke just before serving.

4 Grilling:

Heat a grill pan or tawa, brush with oil, and grill the chicken on both sides until golden brown. Alternatively, grill in a preheated oven at 220°C for 5–6 min. Once cooked, let it cool slightly, then shred into thin strips. Keep aside.

PREP: 30 min

MARINATE: 120 min

COOK: 50 min

INGREDIENTS

1 kg boneless chicken

FOR THE MARINATION (MASALA):

2 tbsp. mustard

2 tbsp. Kashmiri lal mirch powder

2 tbsp. ginger-garlic paste
(Adrak-lehsun paste)

1 tbsp. Dhaniya powder

1 tsp. Jeera powder

½ tsp. Haldi powder

1 tsp. Kasuri methi

1 tsp. Amchur powder

½ tsp. Kala namak

1 tsp. Garam masala

1 tbsp. fresh mint (pudina),
finely chopped

1 tbsp. fresh coriander
(Hara dhaniya), finely chopped

salt (as per taste)

½ cup thick curd (Dahi)

1 tbsp. lemon juice (Nimbu ras)

Live charcoal + desi ghee
(for dhungar/smoking)

oil (Tel) – for grilling



INGREDIENTS

MAKHANI GRAVY BASE

- 2 tbsp. oil (Tel)
- 1 tsp. Jeera
- 3–4 medium onions (Pyaz), sliced
- 10–15 cloves garlic (Lehsun)
- 1-inch piece ginger (Adrak)
roughly chopped
- 3–4 nos Hari mirch

POWDERED MASALE

- 2 tbsp. Kashmiri lal mirch
- 1 tbsp. Dhaniya powder
- ½ tsp. Haldi
- ½ tsp. Kasuri methi
- 6–7 nos whole Kashmiri lal mirch
- 3–4 nos green cardamom (Elaichi)
- 1 kg tomatoes (Tamatar)
roughly chopped
- ⅓ cup cashew nuts (Kaju)
- small handful coriander stems & roots
(Hara dhaniya ke danthal aur jad)
- Namak (to taste)
- 2 tbsp. butter (Makhan)

INSTRUCTIONS MAKHANI GRAVY BASE

- 5 Heat oil in a patila (deep pan), add jeera and sliced pyaz. Sauté till golden brown.
- 6 Add lehsun, adrak, hari mirch, powdered masalas, whole lal mirch, and elaichi. Cook for 1 min.
- 7 Add tamatar, kaju, hara dhaniya ke danthal, namak, and makhan. Mix and cook on medium flame for 5 min.
- 8 Lower the heat, cover, and cook for 25–30 min., stirring occasionally. (Tomatoes will release their own water; add a little hot water only if it starts to dry out.)
- 9 Once tomatoes are completely cooked, turn off the gas and cool the mixture.
- 10 Blend to a fine paste (add ice cubes if in a hurry).
- 11 Strain through a sieve to get a smooth, silky Makhani gravy base. Keep aside.

INGREDIENTS

2 tbsp. butter (Makhan)

1 tsp. oil (Tel)

1 medium Pyaz (chopped)

3 tbsp. Lehsun (chopped)

1 tbsp Adrak (chopped)

2–3 nos. Hari mirch, slit

1 tbsp. Kashmiri lal mirch

Prepared Makhani gravy base

Garam pani (hot water) (as required)

1 tsp. Cheeni or shahad
(sugar/honey)

Grilled chicken (shredded)

½ tsp. Kasuri methi (lightly roasted)

½ tsp. Garam masala

Namak (to taste)

2 tbsp. Makhan

5–6 tbsp. Malai (fresh cream)

Hara dhaniya
finely chopped (for garnish)

INSTRUCTIONS—BUTTER CHICKEN (MURGH MAKHANI) FINAL PREPARATION

12 Heat makhan and tel in a kadhai. Add pyaz, lehsun, adrak, and hari mirch. Sauté till onions turn translucent.

13 Lower the flame, add Kashmiri lal mirch, and cook for 30 seconds.

14 Add the Makhani gravy base and some garam pani to adjust consistency.

15 Add cheeni/shahad and cook for 15–20 min. on medium flame, stirring occasionally.

16 Add shredded grilled chicken, mix well, and simmer for 5–6 min.

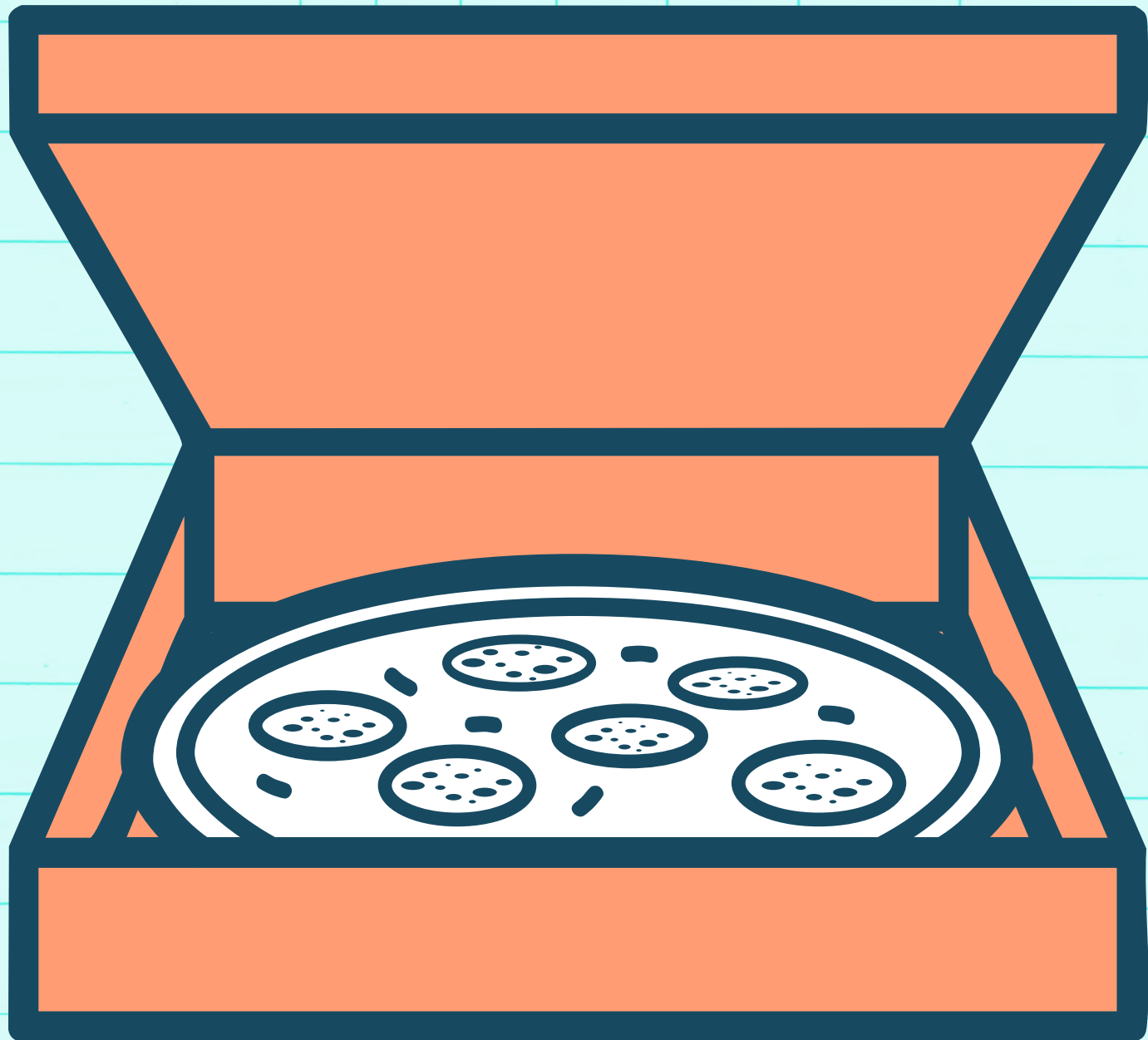
16 Add kasuri methi, garam masala, and namak as needed.

17 Lower the flame, add makhan and malai, mix well, and cook just for a minute (do not boil after adding cream).

18 Garnish with hara dhaniya.

Serve your creamy, smoky Murgh Makhani hot with butter garlic naan, tandoori roti, or lachha paratha.

› The perfect food to give you time to think about deep stuff ...like life choices. ‹



GUSTAVSSON’S SPECIAL

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1 Pre-heat oven.
- 2 Throw in Dr. Oetker salami pizza.
- 3 Wait 11 min.
- 4 Eat.
- 5 Question life choices.

PREP: 5 min

BAKE: 11 min

SERVINGS: 1

INGREDIENTS

Dr. Oetker Salami Pizza



TURKISH LAMB HOTPOT WITH A POTATO CRUST

INSTRUCTIONS

PREP: 45 min

BAKE: 80 min

SERVINGS: 4

INGREDIENTS

½ shoulder lamb, boned
(ask your butcher to do this),
excessive fat removed, meat
cut into bite-size chunks

1 tsp. allspice

2 tsp. ground cumin

Salt and black pepper

1 large onion quartered

2 cloves garlic

2 tbsp. olive oil,
plus extra for brushing

2 aubergines
cut into chunks

Small handful mint leaves
roughly chopped

Small handful marjoram
roughly chopped

200 ml lamb stock
(use 1 supermarket tub)

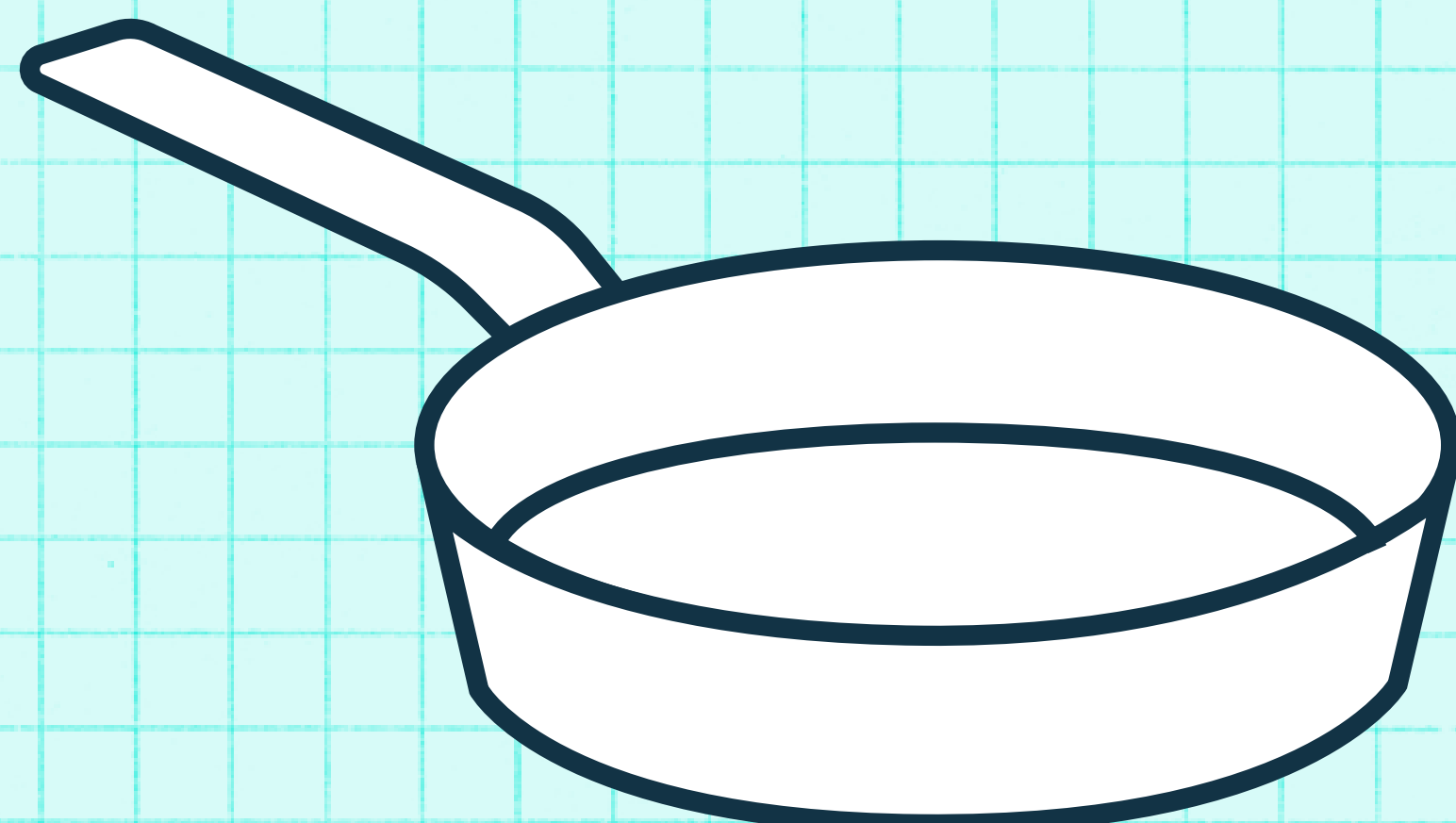
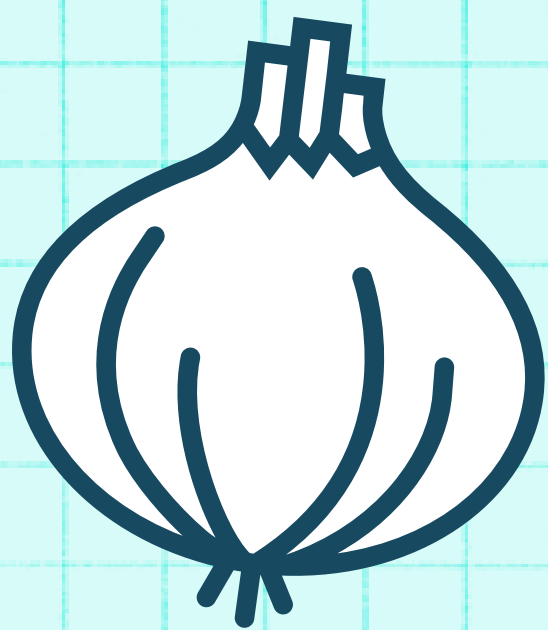
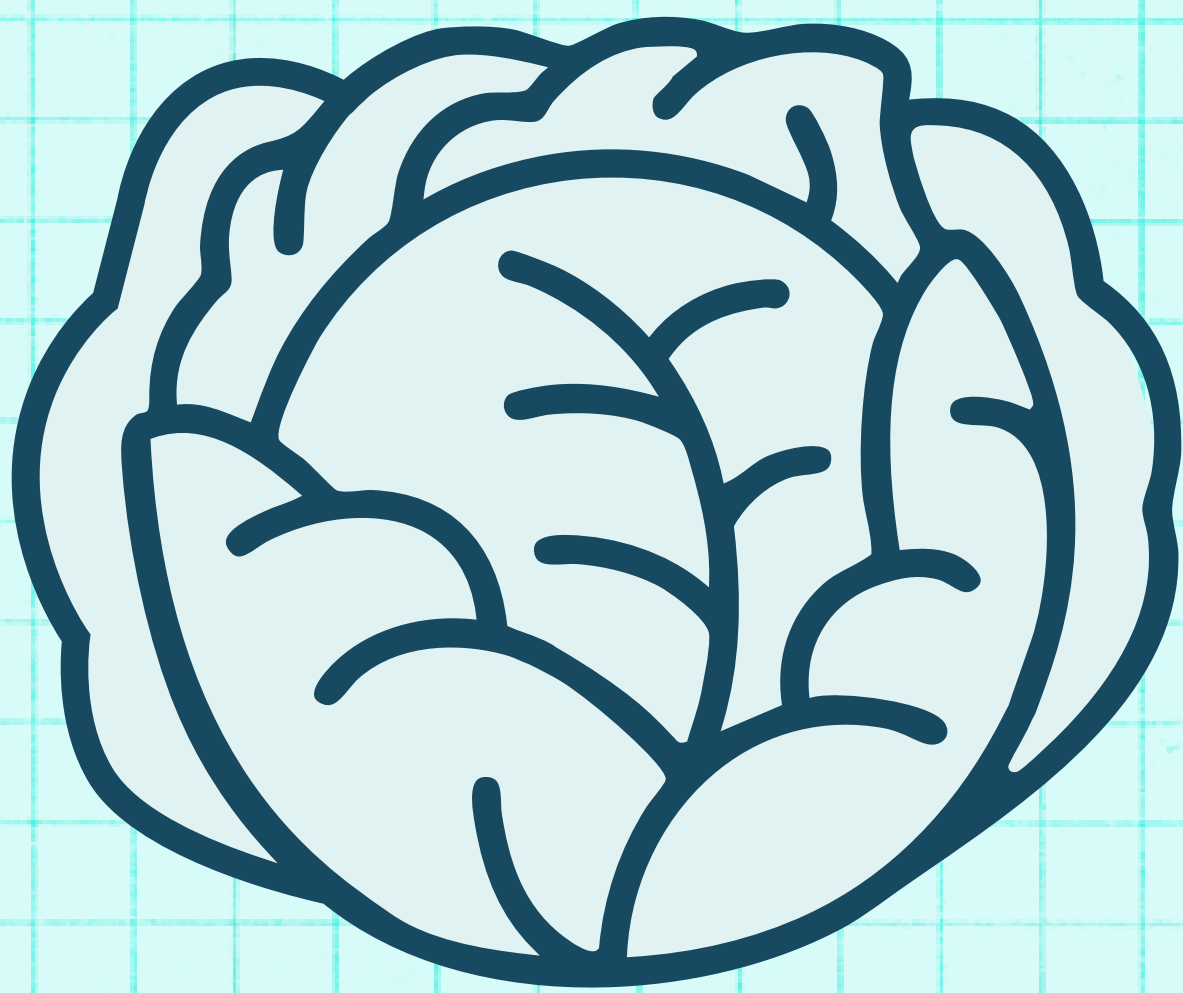
1 tbsp. small raisins

3 baking potatoes
peeled and sliced

- 1** Toss the lamb with the allspice and cumin, and some salt and pepper. Blast the onion and garlic to a mush in a food processor, then mix with the lamb. Leave to one side for about an hour.
- 2** Add 2 tbsp. olive oil and mix together, then briefly fry the lamb to cook out the spices. Remove from the heat, add all the remaining ingredients, except the potatoes, and distribute between four individual ovenproof pots (or put into a wide casserole pan). Cover with a layer of sliced potatoes, season and brush all over with oil, and cover with foil.
- 3** Bake at 190°C/375F/Gas Mark 4 for an hour, then remove the foil, turn the oven up to 220°C/425F/Gas Mark 7 and bake for a further 20 min., or until the potatoes start to crisp.

» This is a traditional Polish dish. It always reminds me of my childhood home because it was often served at Christmas, Easter, and other family gatherings.

My wife makes them from time to time. They disappear very quickly. And yes, both my mum and grandma did it in the past. That's how you knew that Christmas are coming. «



TRADITIONAL CABBAGE ROLLS

PREP: 30 min

COOK: 90 min

INGREDIENTS

700 g minced pork

**1 head of cabbage,
white or Savoy**

1 medium onion

1 tbsp. oil

2 tbsp. breadcrumbs

2 tbsp. tomato paste

1½ cups broth (about 375 ml)

1 tsp. salt

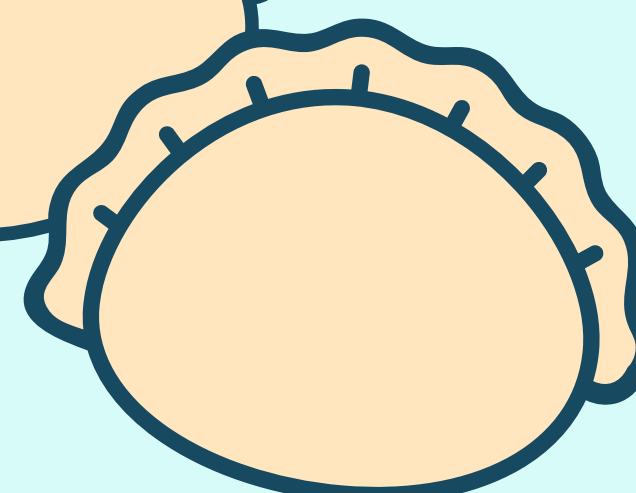
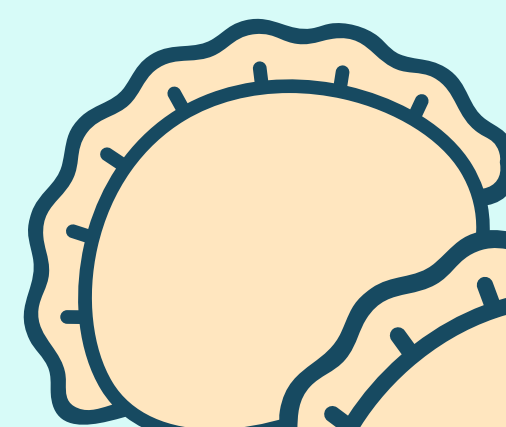
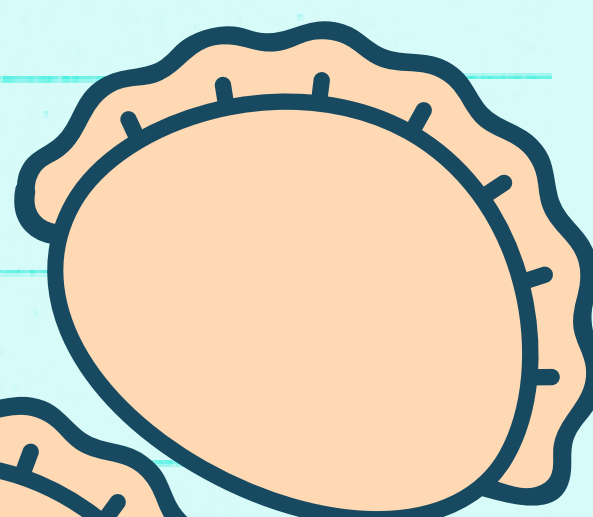
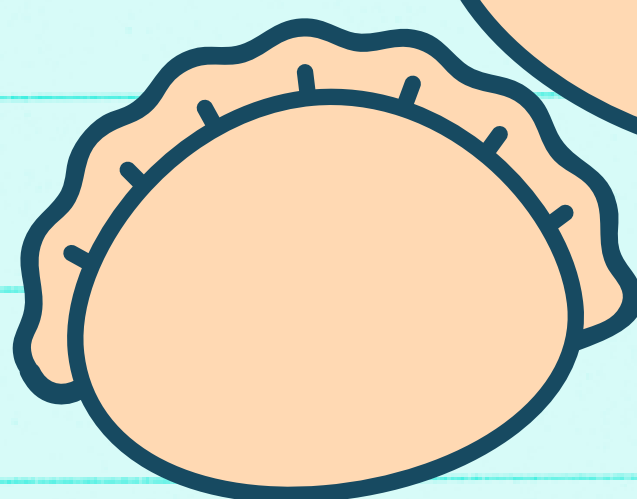
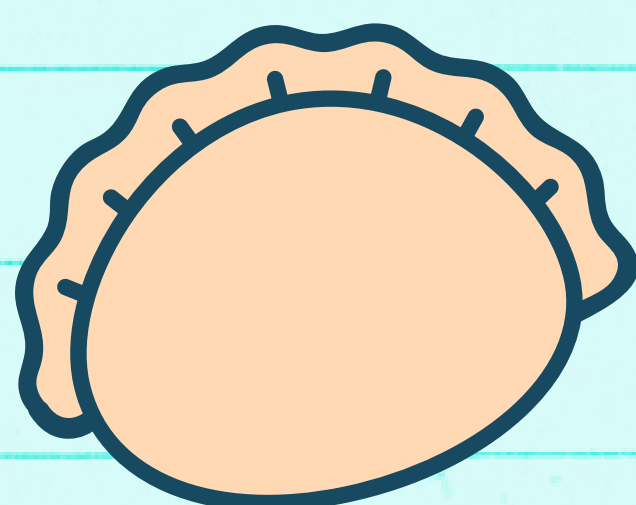
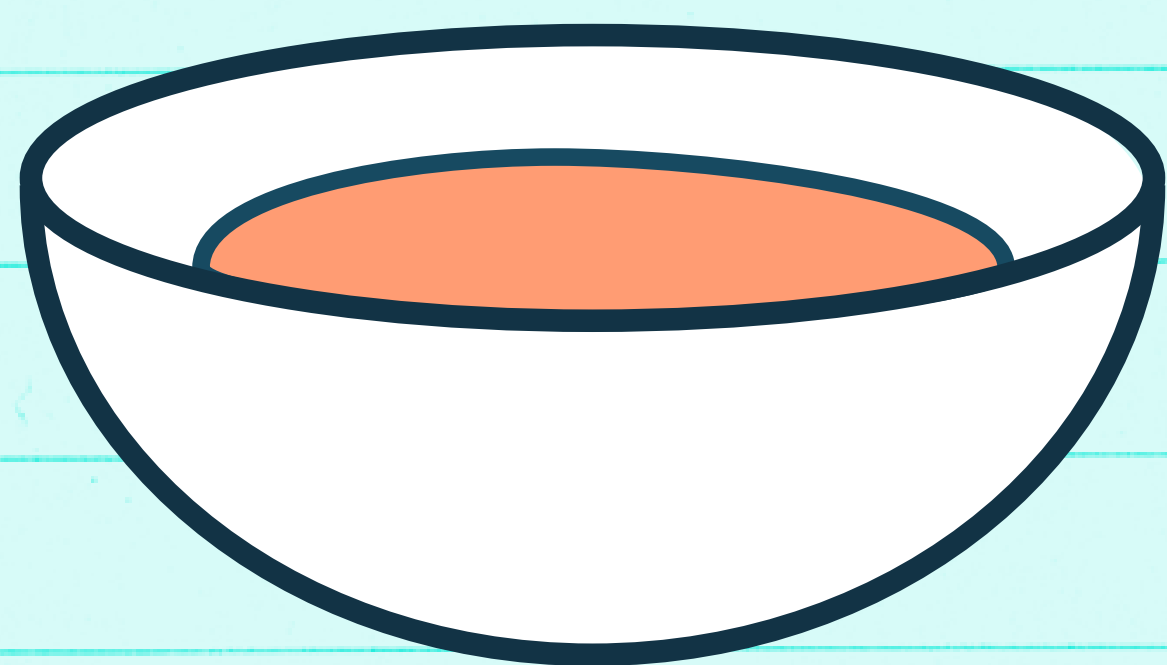
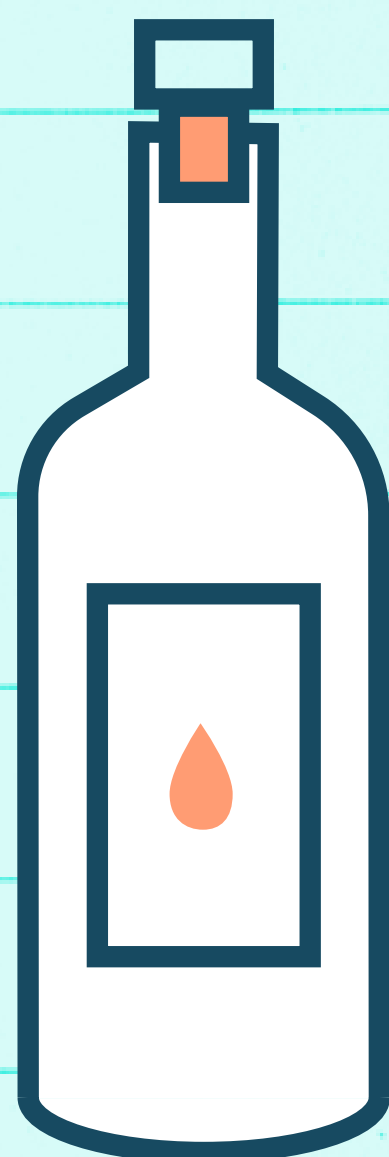
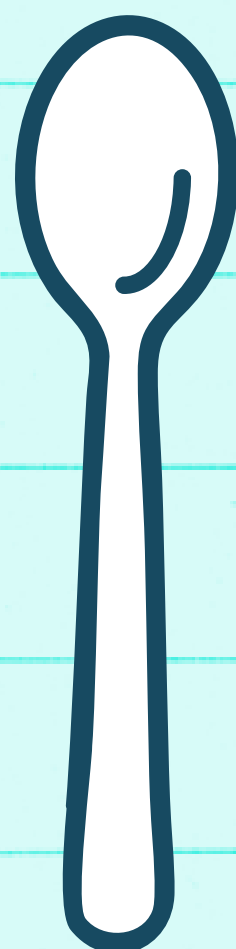
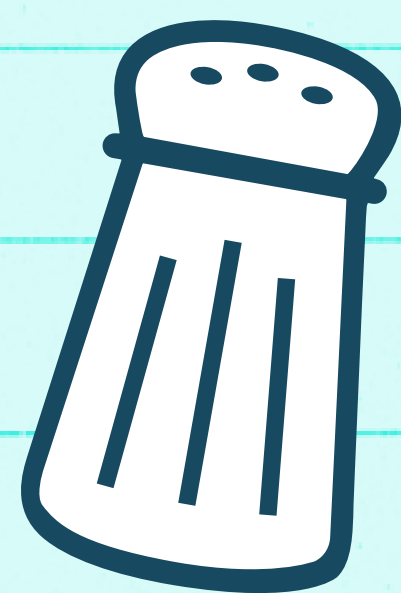
1 tsp. black pepper

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Put the minced pork in a big bowl.
- 2** Peel and chop the onion. Heat oil in a pan. Add the onion and cook for about 5 min. until soft.
- 3** Add the onion to the meat. Add breadcrumbs, salt, and pepper. Mix well.
- 4** Cut out the hard center of the cabbage. Put the cabbage in a big pot with boiling water. After 2–3 min., take off the soft outer leaves. Keep doing this until you have enough leaves.
- 5** Cut off the thick stem from each leaf.
- 6** Put about 2 tablespoons of the meat mix on each leaf. Shape it like a small roll. Fold in the sides and roll it up.
- 7** Put a few leftover cabbage leaves at the bottom of a big pot.
- 8** Place the rolls close together in the pot.
- 9** Mix the broth with tomato paste. Pour it over the rolls so they are almost covered.
- 10** Cover the pot. Cook on low heat for about 1½ hours, until the cabbage is soft.
- 11** Serve warm with potatoes or bread.



» If it's something only indirectly related to cooking, then it would be making dumplings. It always reminds me of the time leading up to Christmas. My wife and I prepare them together, she makes the mushroom and cabbage filling, while I take care of the cutting out the shapes, and filling the dumplings. «



PIEROGI

PREP: 40 min

COOK: 10 min

INGREDIENTS

500 g all-purpose flour

½ tsp. salt

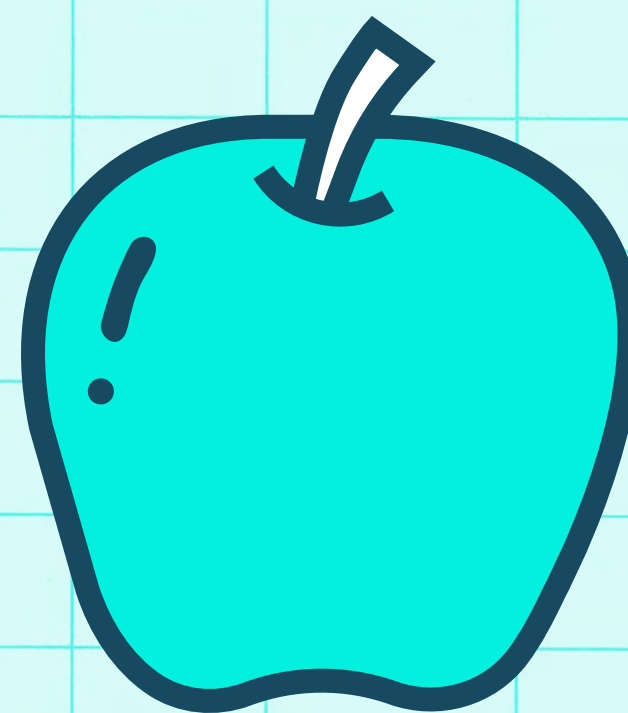
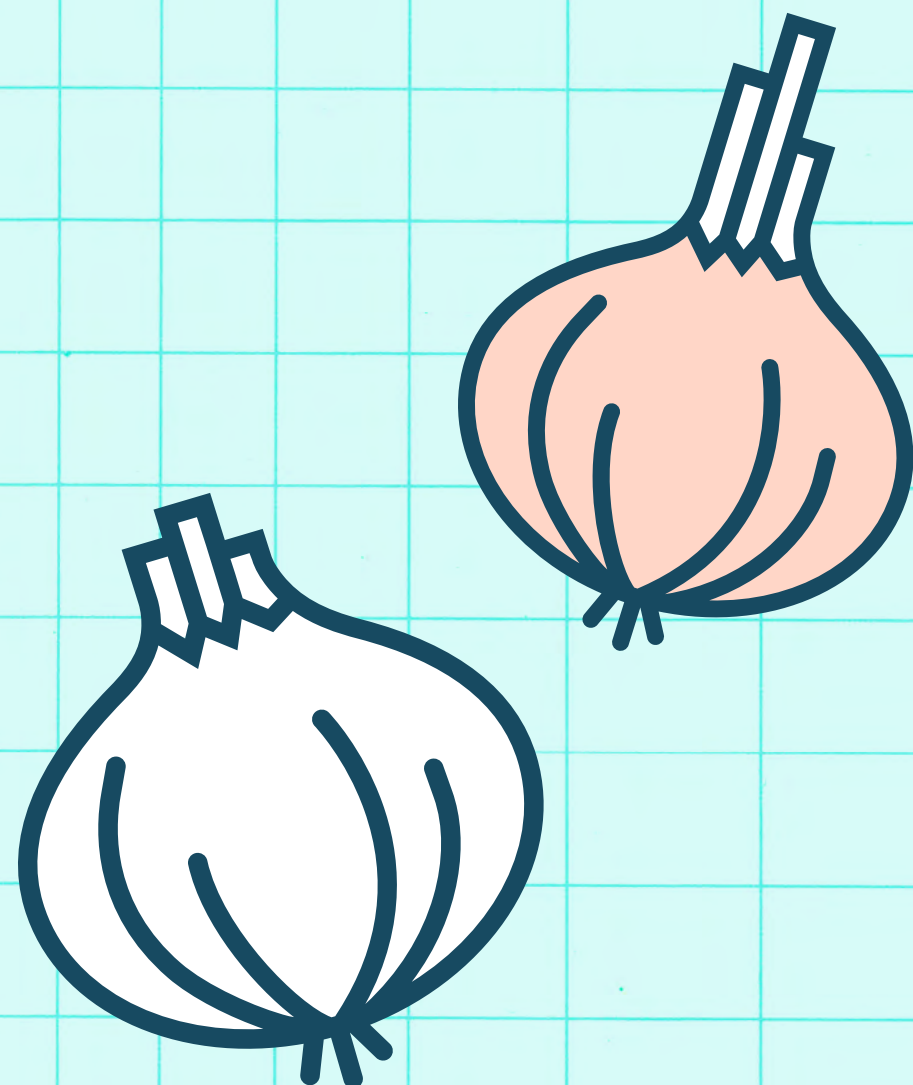
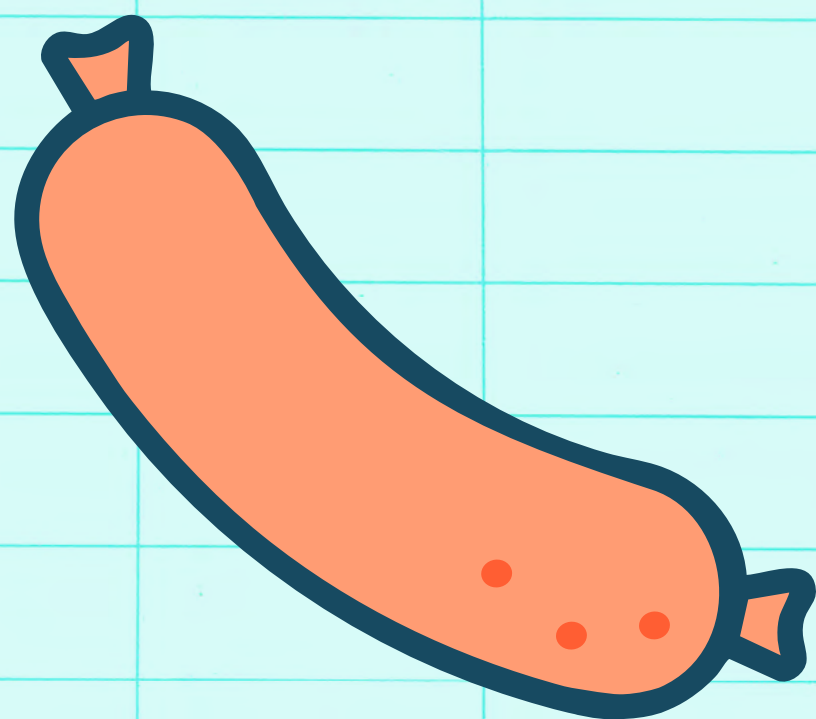
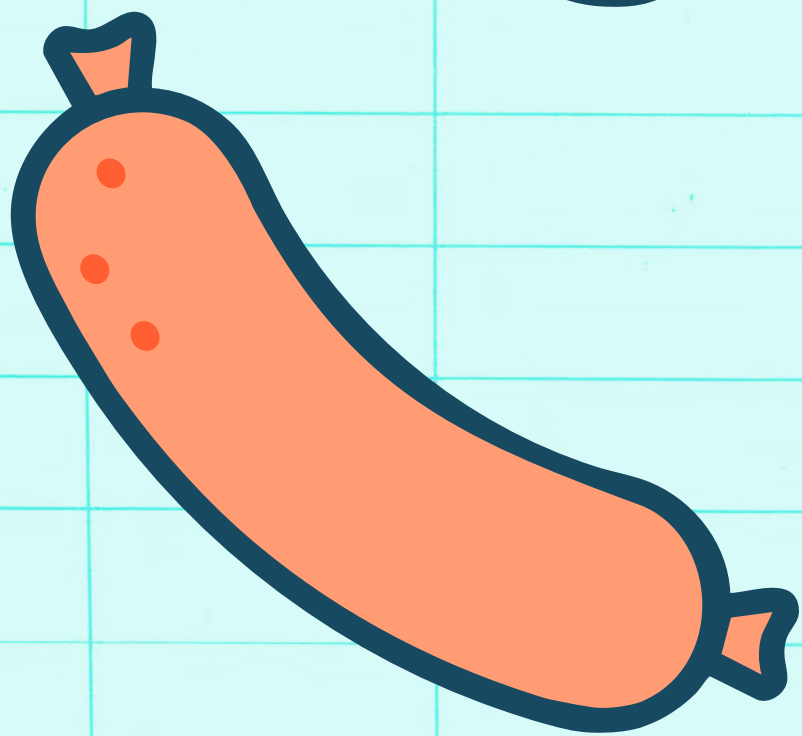
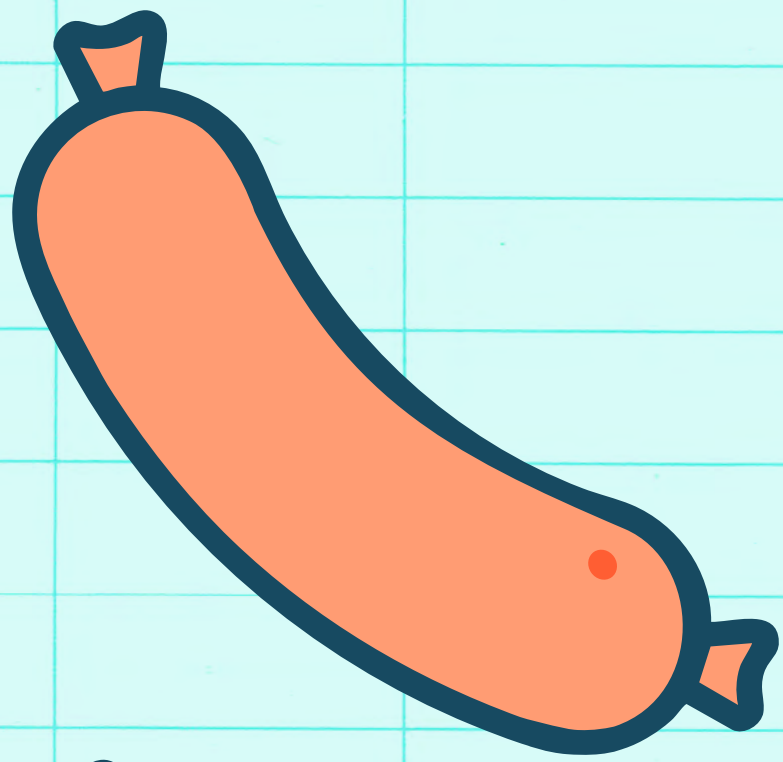
4 tbsp. oil (about 50 ml)

1 cup hot water (about 250 ml)

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Sift the flour into a large bowl.
- 2** Add salt and oil. Pour in the hot water and mix the dough with a spoon at first if it's too hot.
- 3** Knead the dough by hand until it's soft and elastic. You can also use a kitchen machine if you like.
- 4** Wrap the dough in plastic wrap and let it rest for 30 min.
- 5** After resting, divide the dough into 3 parts. Roll out one part thinly on a floured surface.
- 6** Cut out circles and stretch each one a little in your hands.
- 7** Put a spoonful of filling (for example, cabbage and mushroom) in the middle.
- 8** Fold the pierogi in half and press the edges to seal.
- 9** Place them on a board and cover with a damp cloth so they don't dry out.
- 10** Boil the pierogi in salted water. When they float to the top, cook for another 3–4 min., then remove them with a slotted spoon.

Every year on Christmas my father always cooks Christmas dinner. His signature is Sausage meat stuffing. He always cooked two, one for me and one for the rest of the family. It's easy to make and a perfect filler for a great dinner. A few slices, some spuds, some veg and lots of gravy with a glass of wine and you'll be full and happy. Also if vegetarian the sausage meat can be replaced with vegetarian sausages and is equally as delicious.



> SAUSAGE, SAGE AND ONION STUFFING

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Fry 2 sliced onions in 25 g butter for 5 mins., then add 1 small diced Bramley apple and cook briefly.
- 2** Cool, then mix with 800 g Cumberland sausages, skins removed, the chopped handful of sage, 140 g granary breadcrumbs and seasoning.
- 3** Use to stuff the neck end of the bird, then roll any leftovers into balls. Or, pack the whole mixture into a 1 kg loaf tin and top with extra sage leaves.
- 4** Bake with turkey for 30–40 mins. Drain off any fat and serve sliced.

PREP: 20 min

COOK: 40 min

SERVINGS: 8–10

INGREDIENTS

2 onions sliced

25 g butter

1 small Bramley apple
peeled, cored and diced

2 x 400 g packs meaty Cumberland sausages
removed from their skins

handful sage leaves
chopped, plus extra for topping

140 g granary breadcrumb

› This is a classic and traditional Swabian comfort food and beloved childhood dish from my region, that was always homemade by my mother. I still love and sometimes cook it myself. ‹



» LENTILS WITH SPÄTZLE

PREP: 15 min
COOK: 40 min
SERVINGS: 4

INGREDIENTS

- 1 liter vegetable or meat broth
- 8 Vienna sausages/Frankfurters (or 4 pairs)
- 400 g Spätzle or Knöpfle from the refrigerated section, alternatively homemade
- 250 g plate lentils (German lentils), light brown
- 250 g soup vegetables, uncleaned (celeriac, carrots, leek, parsley)
- 2 tbsp. tomato paste
- 1 red onion (approx. 80 g)
- 40 g butter
- 20 g flour, Type 405 (all-purpose flour)
- 2 bay leaves
- 1 tsp. marjoram (dried)
- 1-2 tbsp. balsamic vinegar (alternatively red wine vinegar)
- Salt (freshly ground)
- Black pepper (freshly ground)

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1 First, clean or peel and wash the 250 g soup vegetables and 1 onion. Cut the onion, carrot, and celery into very small cubes (the lentil vegetables shouldn't be too coarse and chunky!). Clean, wash, and cut the leek into fine pieces as well. Wash the parsley and shake it dry. Rinse the 250 g plate lentils in a sieve if desired.
- 2 Then melt 40 g butter in a medium-sized pot and whisk in 20 g flour with a whisk. Let it bubble over medium heat until the flour-butter mixture is lightly browned.
- 3 Now add the cut vegetables and the 250 g plate lentils to the flour-butter mixture and sauté for 3-5 mins. Then add 2 tbsp tomato paste, 1 tsp dried marjoram, and 2 bay leaves. Pour in 1 liter of broth and stir well. Let the lentil-vegetable mixture simmer in an uncovered pot for 35 mins., stirring occasionally. Add a bit more water if needed.
- 4 Test the lentils: If they're done, season everything with 1-2 tbsp vinegar, approx. ½ tsp salt, and freshly ground black pepper. Remove the bay leaves, finely chop the parsley and stir it in.



NOTE: Only season the lentils with vinegar at the end, as vinegar hardens the lentil skins and they won't soften properly.

5 Now heat the 8 Vienna sausages/frankfurters (4 pairs). To do this, simply place them on top of the finished lentil vegetables and let them heat for 5 min. with the lid closed. (Or let them steep separately in a pot with hot water for a few mins).

6 Meanwhile, add the spätzle to boiling salted water and let them cook for 1 min. Drain and stir in 1 tsp butter flakes.

7 Serve the lentil vegetables with sausages and spätzle. Enjoy your Swabian meal!

Guten Appetit!



BEEF WELLINGTON

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Put the mushrooms into a food processor with some seasoning and pulse to a rough paste. Scrape the paste into a pan and cook over a high heat for about 10 min., tossing frequently, to cook out the moisture from the mushrooms. Spread out on a plate to cool.
- 2** Heat in a frying pan and add a little olive oil. Season the beef and sear in the hot pan for 30 secs only on each side. (You don't want to cook it at this stage, just colour it). Remove the beef from the pan and leave to cool, then brush all over with the mustard.
- 3** Lay a sheet of cling film on a work surface and arrange the Parma ham slices on it, in slightly overlapping rows. With a palette knife, spread the mushroom paste over the ham, then place the seared beef fillet in the middle. Keeping a tight hold of the cling film from the edge, neatly roll the Parma ham and mushrooms around the beef to form a tight barrel shape. Twist the ends of the cling film to secure. Chill for 15–20 min. to allow the beef to set and keep its shape.

PREP: 20 min

COOK: 15 min

CHILL: 20 min

BAKE: 35 min

INGREDIENTS

400 g flat cap mushrooms
roughly chopped

sea salt and freshly ground black pepper

olive oil (for cooking)

750 g piece of prime beef fillet

1–2 tbsp. English mustard

6–8 slices of Parma ham

500 g ready-made puff pastry

flour (to dust)

2 egg yolks, beaten

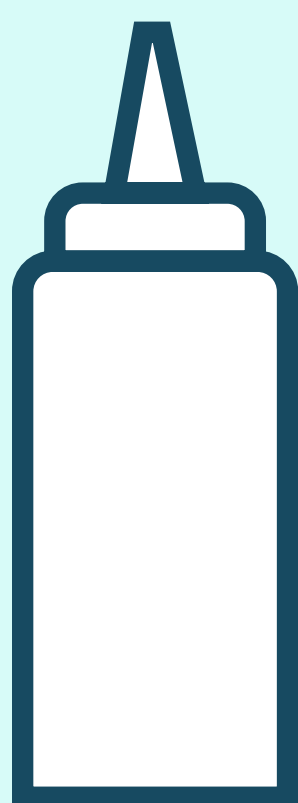
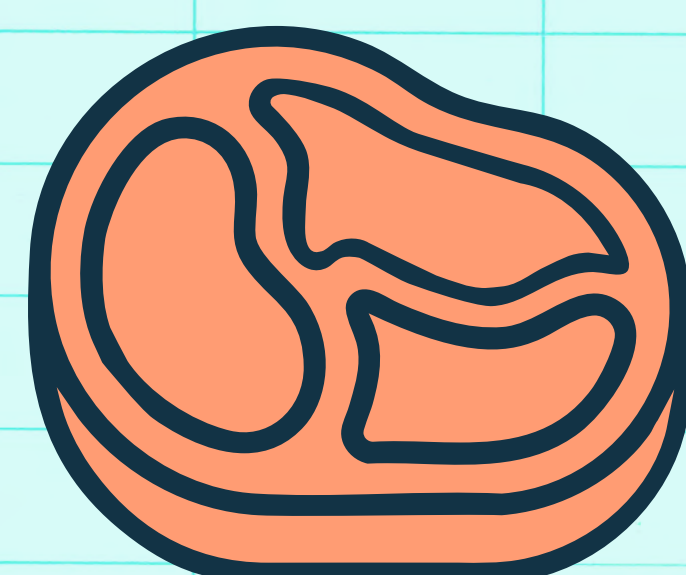
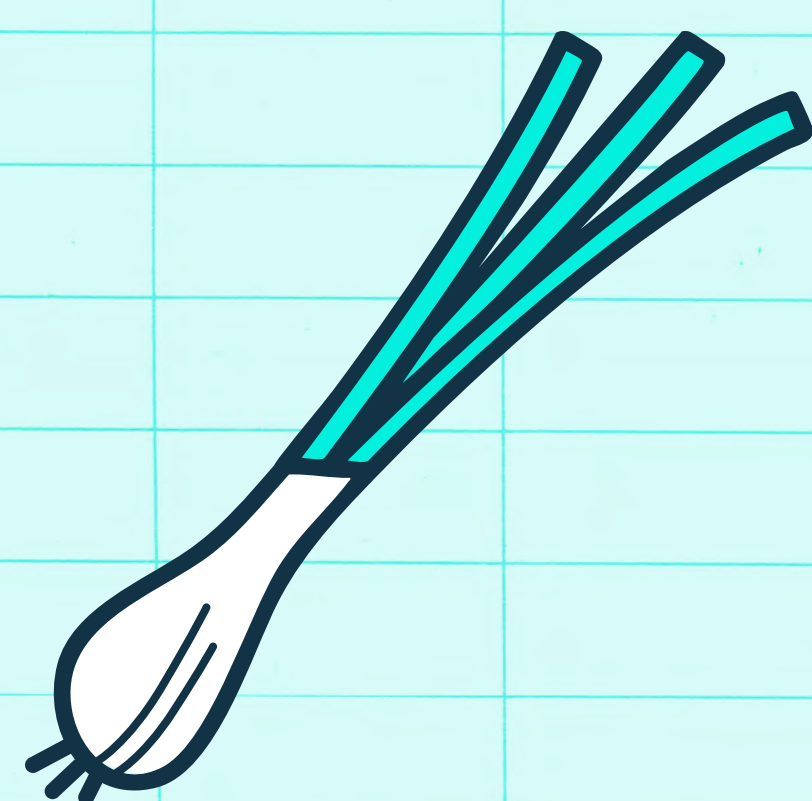
4 Roll out the puff pastry on a floured surface to a large rectangle, the thickness of a £1 coin. Remove the cling film from the beef, then lay in the centre. Brush the surrounding pastry with egg yolk. Fold the ends over, then wrap the pastry around the beef, cutting off any excess. Turn over, so the seam is underneath, and place on a baking sheet. Brush over all the pastry with egg and chill for about 15 min. to let the pastry rest.

5 Heat the oven to 200°C, 400F, gas 6.

6 Lightly score the pastry at 1 cm intervals and glaze again with beaten egg yolk. Bake for 20 min., then lower the oven setting to 180 °C, 350F, gas 4 and cook for another 15 min.

Allow to rest for 10–15 min. before slicing and serving with the side dishes of your choice.

The beef should still be pink in the centre when you serve it.



When the Asian market opened in town, we went a bit overboard buying new sauces. This bowl is what we figured out after playing around with what we brought home. It's basically our weekday lunch now. One of us cooks the beef while the other makes the sauce, mix the bulgogi sauce with gochujang, soy sauce, vinegar, honey, and garlic. It's got a good kick but the honey keeps it balanced. Fry up a couple eggs, toss everything over rice, add some scallions and sesame seeds. The whole thing takes about 20 min. and uses stuff we usually have around. It's spicy enough to feel like a treat but easy enough that we don't think twice about making it when we're working from home. Quick and filling.

LUNCHTIME BULGOGI BOWL

PREP: 10 min

COOK: 10 min

SERVINGS: 2

INGREDIENTS

3 beef minute steaks/
medallions

1 cup of rice

2 eggs

SAUCE

4 tbsp. korean pork bolgogi
sauce

1 tbsp. gochujang

2 tbsp. soy sauce (dark/light)

1 tbsp. rice wine vinegar

1 tbsp. honey

½ tbsp. garlic paste

GARNISH

Pinch of sesame seeds

2 scallions (chopped)

INSTRUCTIONS

1 Begin by cooking your rice in a rice cooker or pot, salt the water beforehand.

2 While the rice is cooking, chop your beef medallions into thin (very thin) strips.

3 Prepare the sauce by mixing the bulgogi, gochujang, soy sauce, rice wine vinegar, honey and garlic paste in a cup.

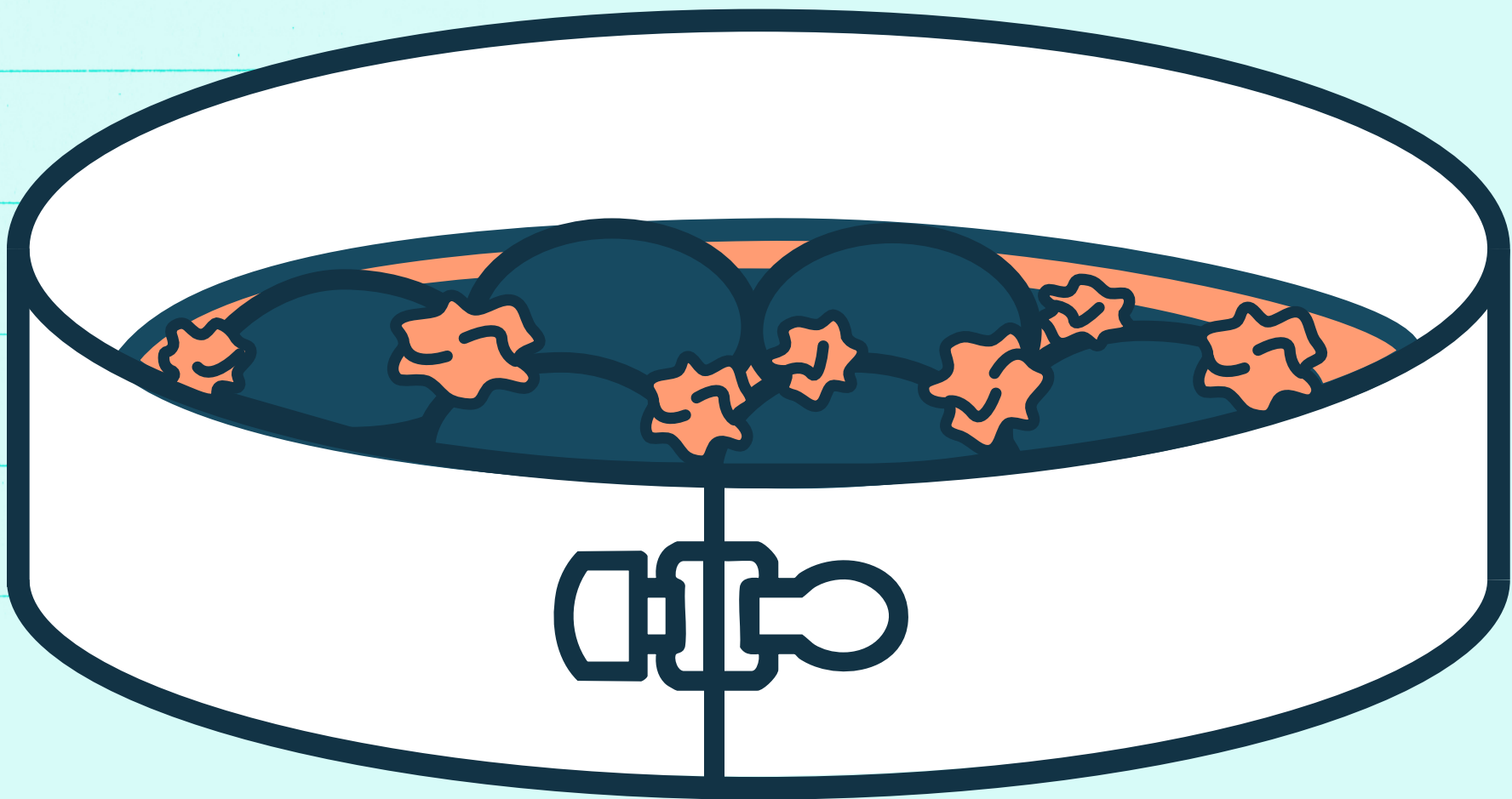
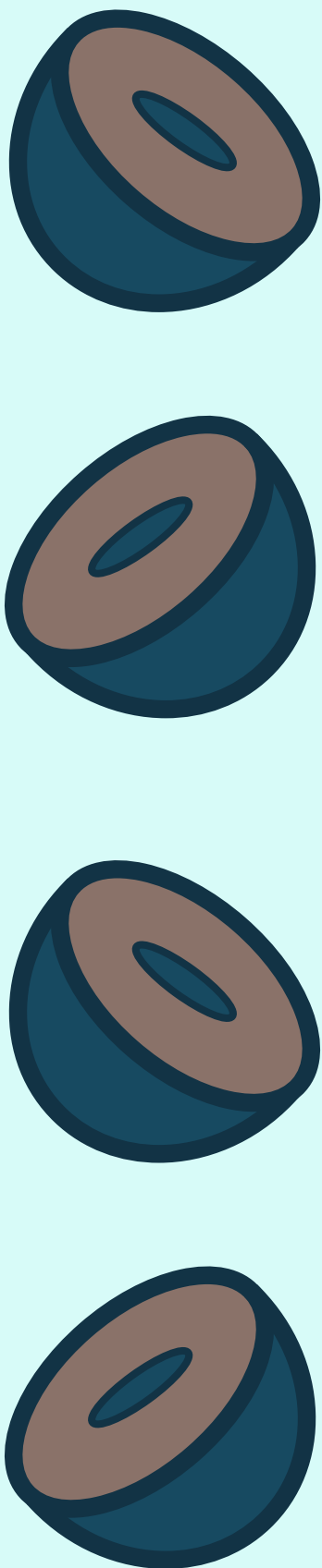
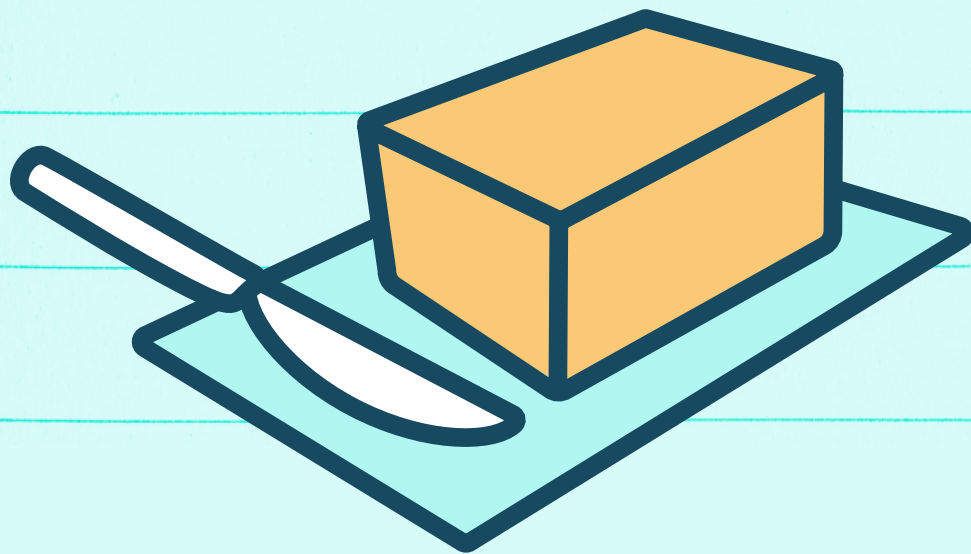
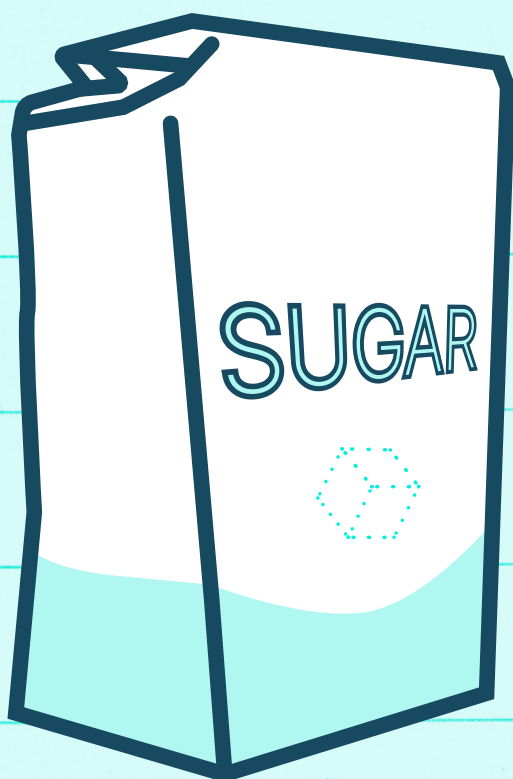
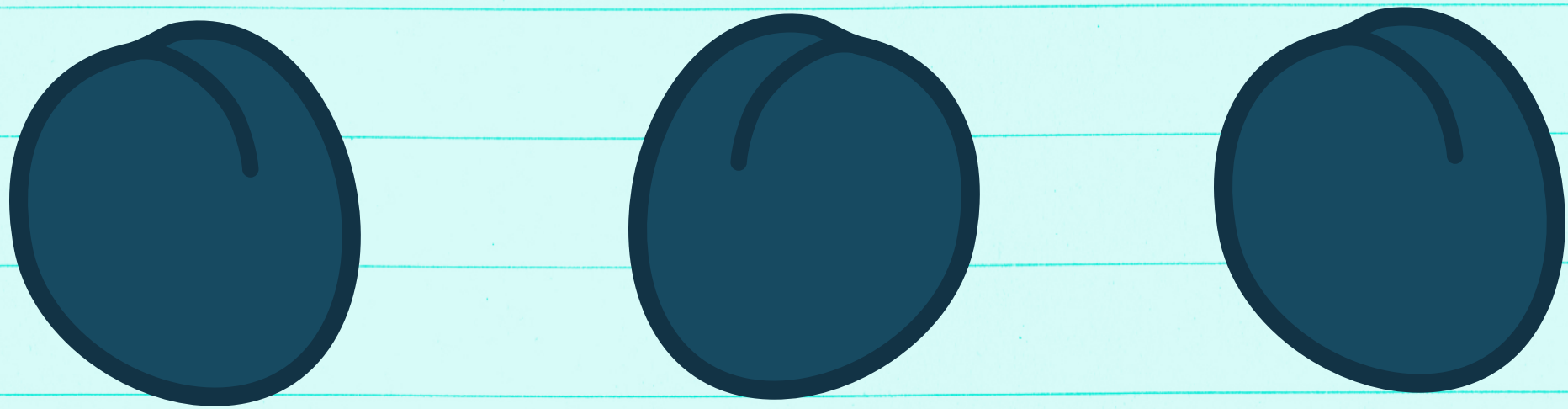
4 Pre-heat a skillet on medium-high heat.

5 Cook the beef medallions on the skillet until brown, pour the sauce into the skillet and lower heat, mixing often to avoid burning the honey.

6 While the sauce is cooking into the meat, crack two eggs into a pan and cook sunny side up.

7 Divide cooked rice into two bowls, top with cooked beef, egg, chopped scallions, and a pinch of sesame seeds.

8 Serve!



PLUM PIE

PREP: 30 min

BAKE: 60–80 min

INGREDIENTS

12 to 16 plums
(depending on size)

200 g margarine or mustard
(depending on personal preference)

220 g wheat flour

80 g rolled oats

180 g sugar
(or 100 g sugar plus another sweetener)

1 packet vanilla sugar

1 pinch of salt

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Allow the butter to soften slightly.
- 2** Preheat the oven to 200°C (top/bottom heat) or 180°C (fan).
- 3** Grease the springform pan with butter.
- 4** Put the butter, flour, rolled oats, sugar, vanilla sugar, and salt into a mixing bowl.
- 5** Using a hand mixer with a whisk, mix until coarse crumbs form.
- 6** If the dough doesn't come together, shape it briefly by hand into small balls, then continue mixing until crumbly.
- 7** Set aside about half of the crumble for the topping.
- 8** Sprinkle a few handfuls of crumble onto the base of the pan and press down by hand to form a thin, even crust—as thin as possible, but still firm enough to hold together.
- 9** Shape some of the dough into “sausages” and press them along the edge of the pan to create a rim about 2 cm high.



10 Cut large plums into quarters and small ones into halves. Arrange them alternately skin-side up and flesh-side up, covering the base completely without overlapping. (If you have too many plums, save the rest for another use.)

11 Sprinkle the remaining crumble loosely over the plums.

12 Cover the pan loosely with aluminum foil.

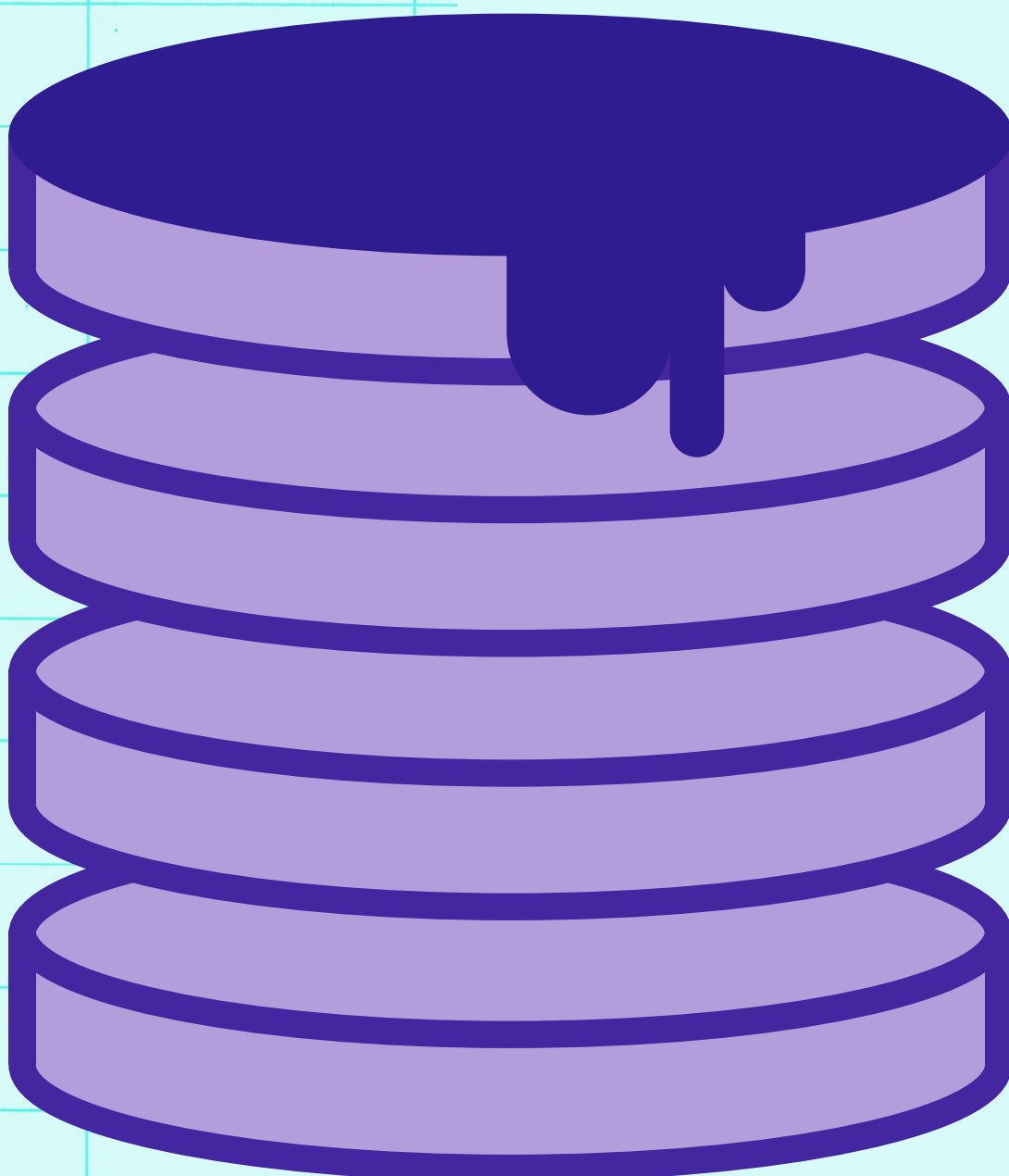
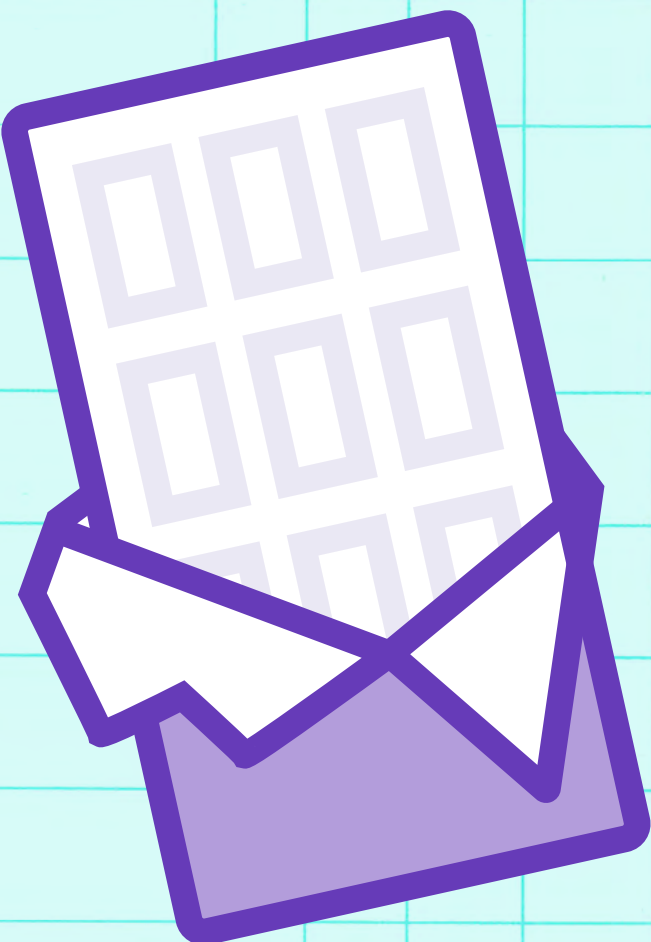
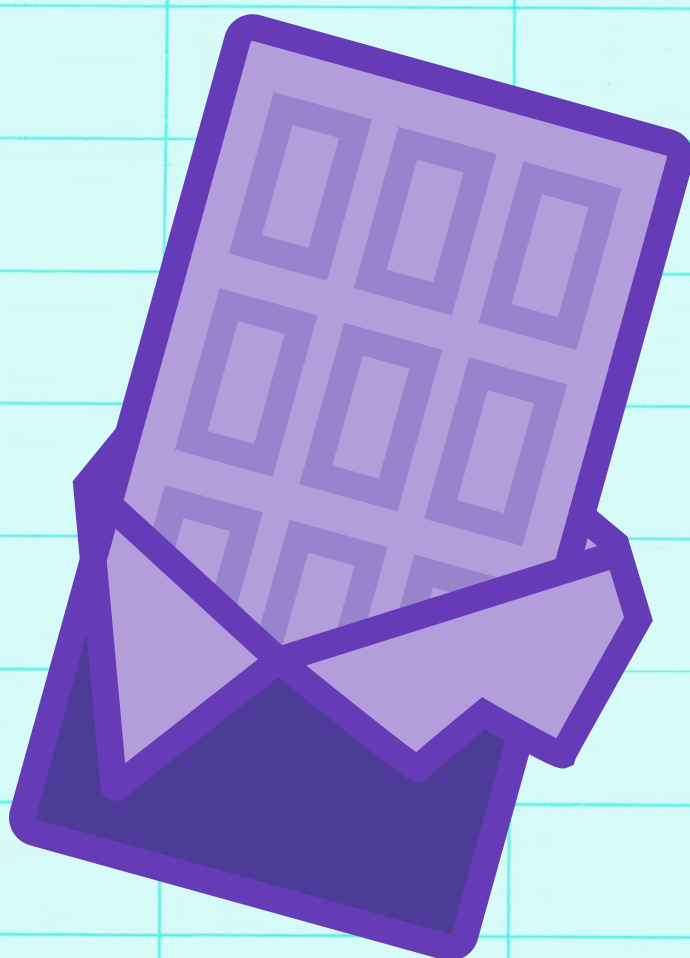
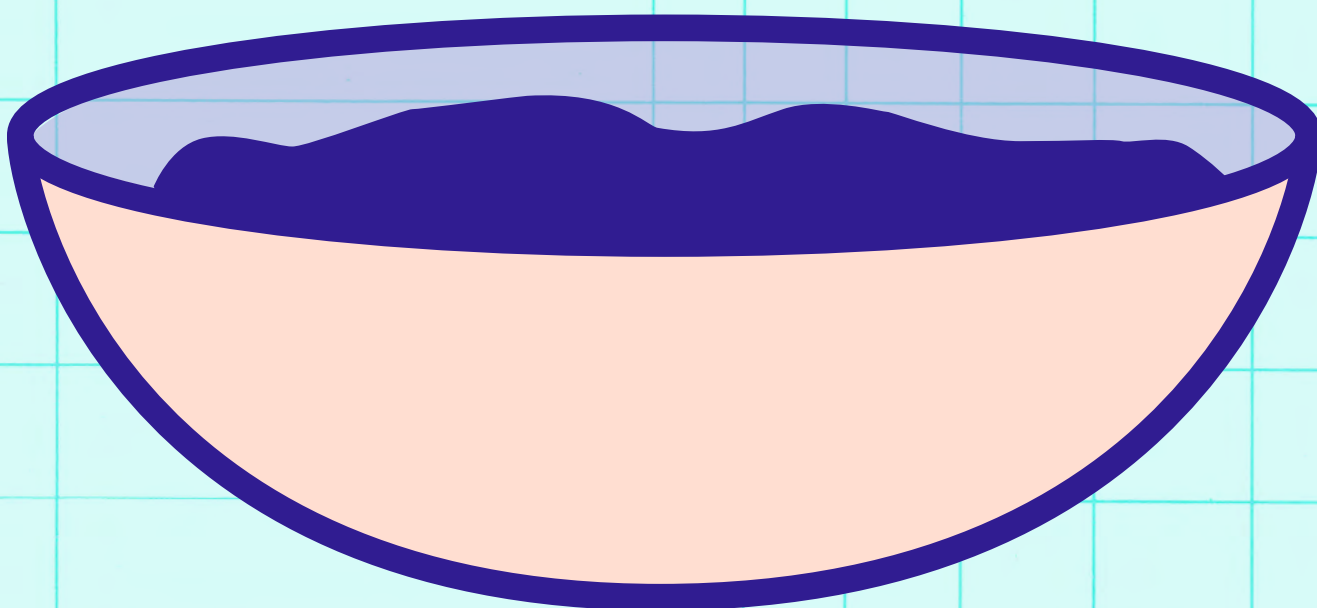
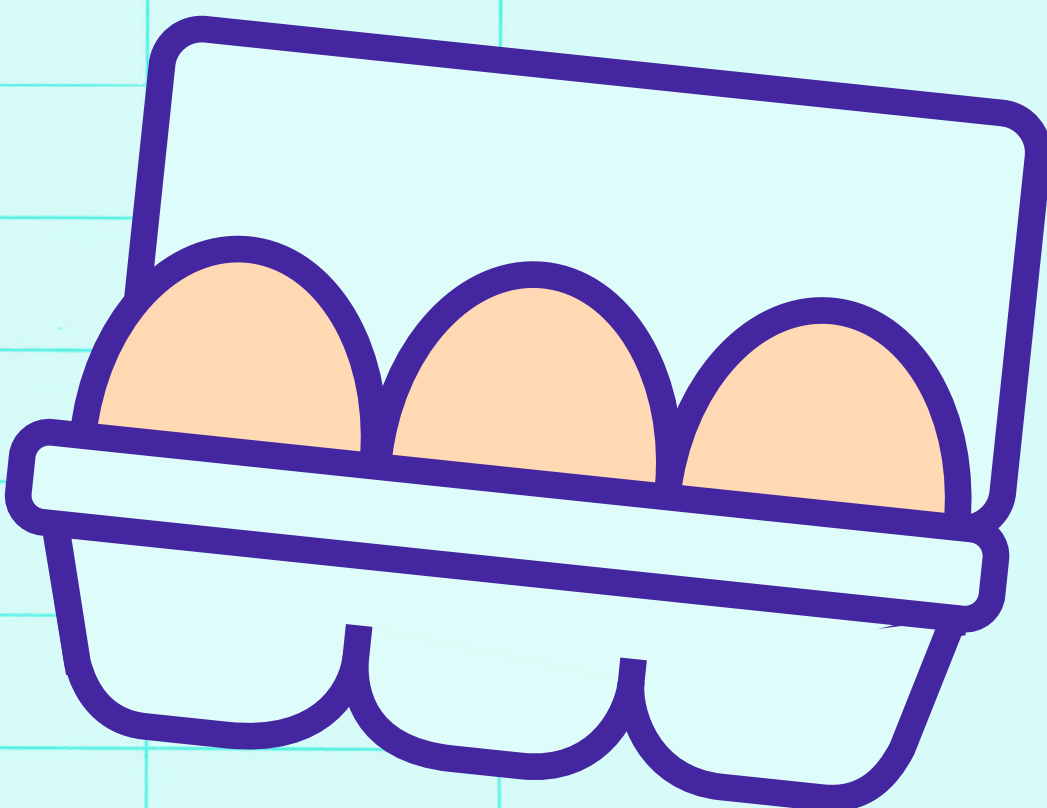
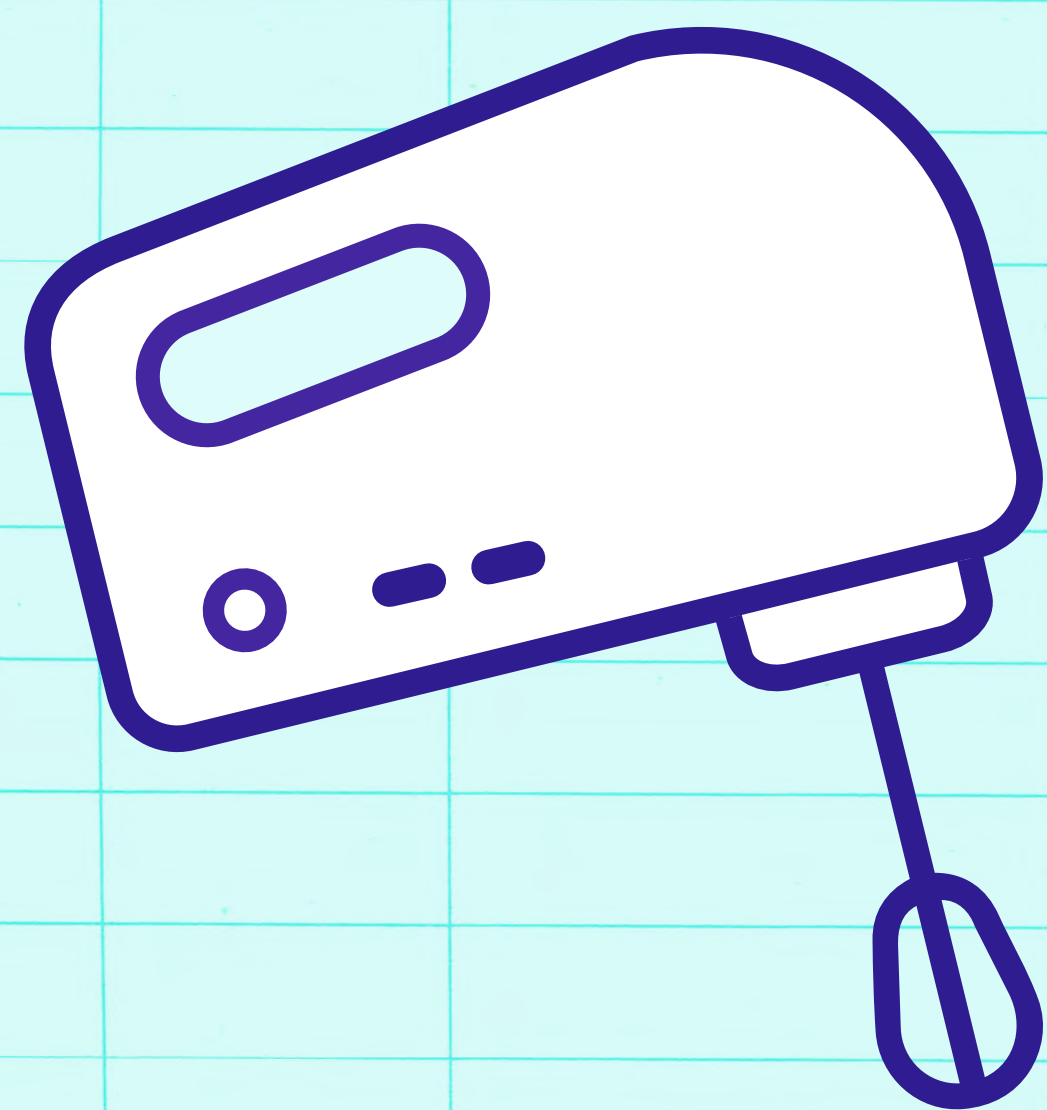
13 Bake for about 60–80 min., checking after 50 min.

14 Remove the foil once the plums have softened (after about 40–50 min.)

15 Continue baking until the crumble is golden brown.

16 Let the cake cool slightly before removing from the pan.

› My youngest daughter has baked this cake for Christmas for many years now—it’s now part of our family traditions... ‹



DARK CHOCOLATE GANACHE CAKE

INGREDIENTS

GANACHE

1 pound chocolate, semisweet
(very finely chopped)

1 pound chocolate, bittersweet
(very finely chopped)

4 cups heavy cream

¼ cup good-quality honey

½ tsp. coarse salt

1 vanilla bean
(split in half lengthwise,
or 1 tbsp. pure vanilla extract)

CHOCOLATE SPONGE CAKE

2 cups all-purpose flour

**1 ⅓ cups good-quality
unsweetened cocoa powder**
(plus extra for dusting)

2 ⅔ cups granulated sugar

1 ½ tsp. baking powder

2 ½ tsp. baking soda

½ tsp. coarse salt

4 large eggs

2 tsp. pure vanilla extract

11 tbsps. unsalted butter, melted
(1 stick plus 3 tablespoons)

1 ⅓ cups buttermilk

**1 ⅓ cups brewed American
coffee**

INSTRUCTIONS

To make the ganache

1 Place all the chocolate in a heatproof bowl, set aside. In a medium saucepan, combine the cream, honey, and salt. Scrape the tiny black seeds from the vanilla bean pod, if using, into the cream, and add the pod. Bring the cream to a boil, pour over the chocolate, and let stand for 5 min. to melt the chocolate. Whisk until smooth. Strain through a fine strainer into a bowl. Discard the vanilla bean. Stir in the vanilla extract, if using. Cover with plastic wrap and let stand at room temperature until the ganache stiffens, at least 6 hours or overnight.

(Or, place in the refrigerator and chill, stirring every 20 to 30 min., until the ganache stiffens.)

2 Preheat the oven to 350°F.

Butter two 9 by 2-inch round cake pans. Line the bottoms with a round of parchment paper and dust with a little bit of cocoa powder, tapping out any excess.

Make the cake

3 In a bowl of an electric mixer fitted with the paddle attachment, sift in the flour, cocoa, sugar, baking powder, baking soda, and salt. Mix on low speed to combine.

PREP: 30 min

REST: 6 h

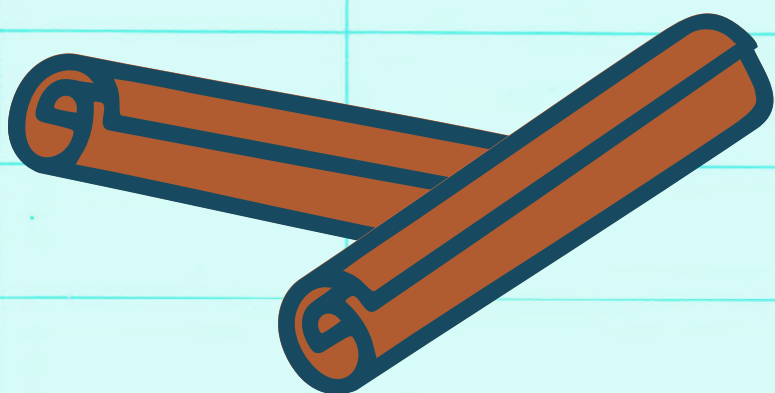
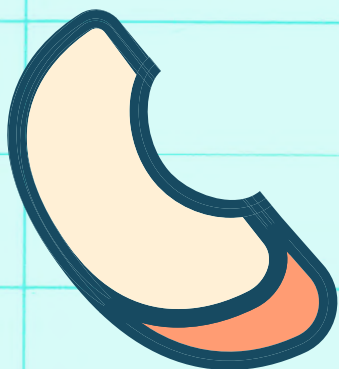
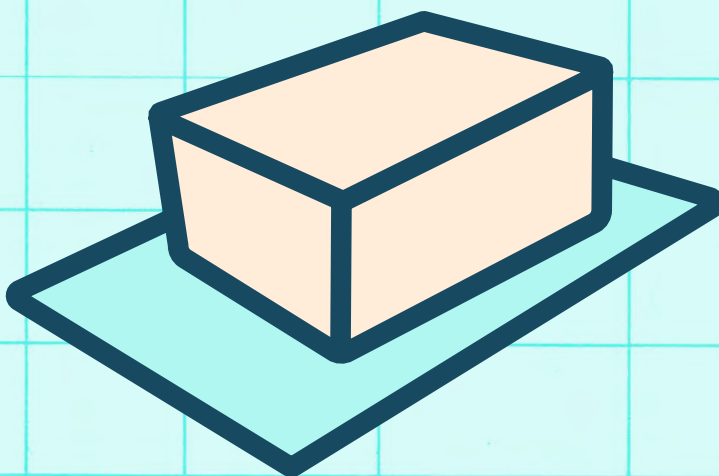
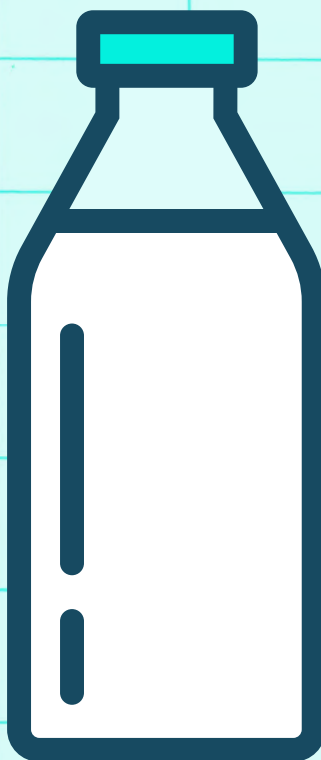
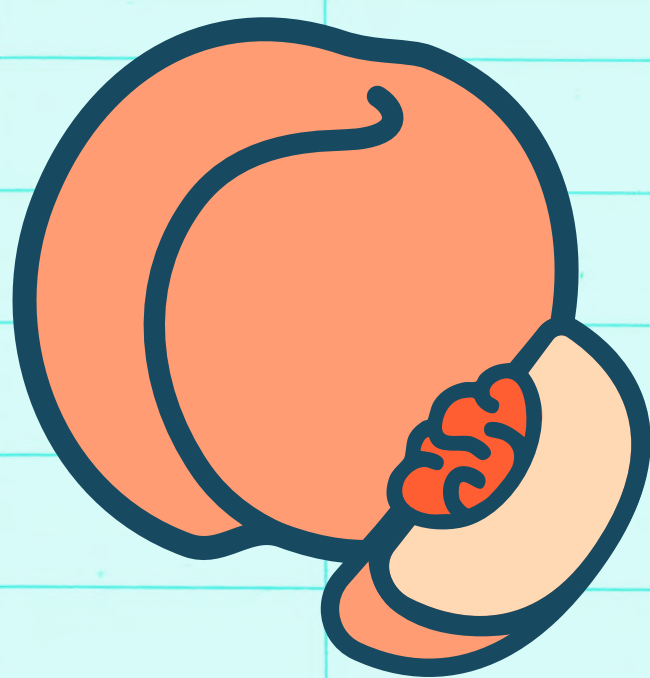
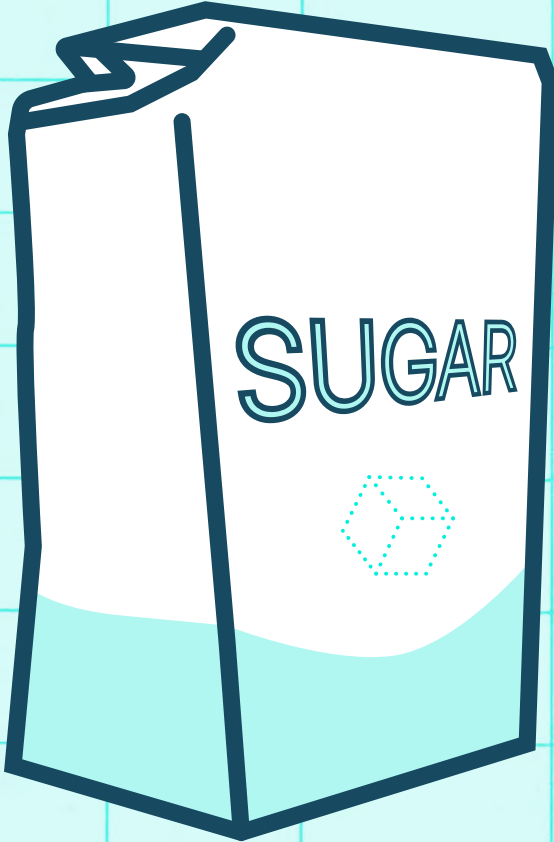
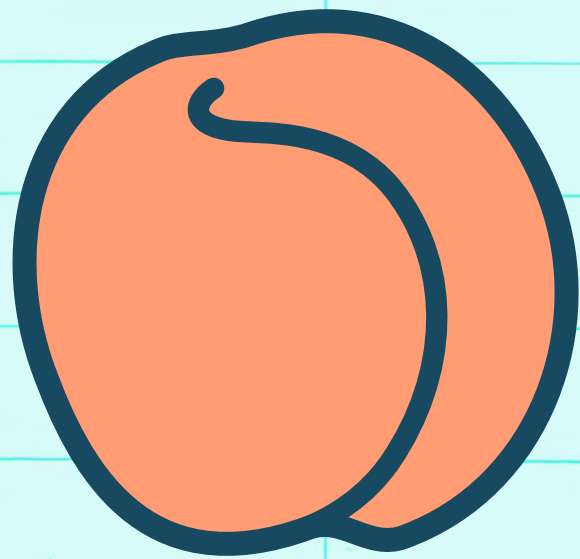
BAKE: 40 min

COOL: 10 min

4 Add the eggs, vanilla, melted butter, buttermilk, and coffee. Mix on low speed until fully combined. Pour the batter into prepared cake pans. Bake on a baking sheet until a cake tester inserted in the middle comes out clean, 35 to 40 min. Transfer to a wire rack and let cool in the pans for 10 min. Then unmold the cakes onto the rack and let cool completely.

5 Using a serrated knife, slice the top about $\frac{1}{4}$ inch off each cake to level it, if necessary. Discard the top pieces. Splice each cake horizontally into two layers for a total of four layers. Place the bottom layer on a 9-inch cake round, a turntable, or a platter, and using an offset spatula, spread thickly with about $1\frac{1}{2}$ cups of the ganache. Repeat with the second and third layers, spreading another $1\frac{1}{2}$ cups ganache over each layer. Add the final cake layer and spread it with a very thin layer of ganache (this is your crumb layer). Place the cake in the refrigerator until the crumb layer is set, about 30 min.

6 Remove the cake from the refrigerator and place it on a wire rack set over a sheet pan. In the top of a double boiler set over simmering water, heat the reserved ganache just until liquid. Pour the ganache over the top of the cake, allowing it to run down the sides. Using a large offset spatula, help spread the ganache from the center to the edges so the cake is completely covered. Smooth the top and sides. Refrigerate to set, about 30 min. Serve at room temperature.



GLUTEN-FREE PEACH COBBLER

PREP: 15 min

BAKE: 45 min

SERVINGS: 12

INGREDIENTS

PEACHES

4 cups fresh peaches
(chopped)

2 tbsp. white sugar

2 tbsp. all-purpose baking flour
gluten-free

1 tsp. ground cinnamon

½ tsp. ground nutmeg

¼ cup unsalted butter
(cut into small pieces)

TOPPING

1 cup all-purpose baking flour
gluten-free

¾ cup white sugar

¾ cup soy milk or whole milk

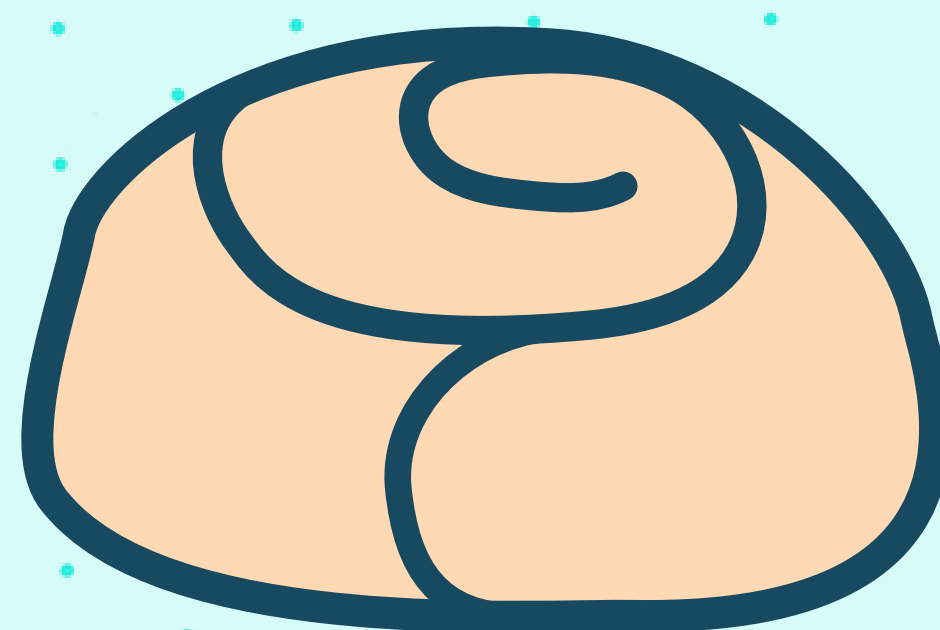
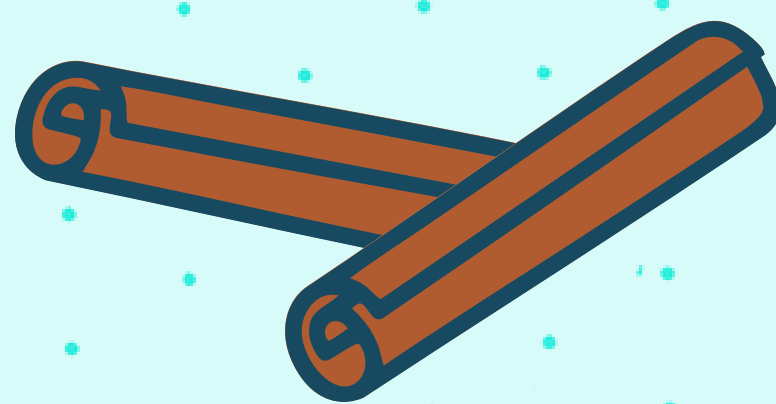
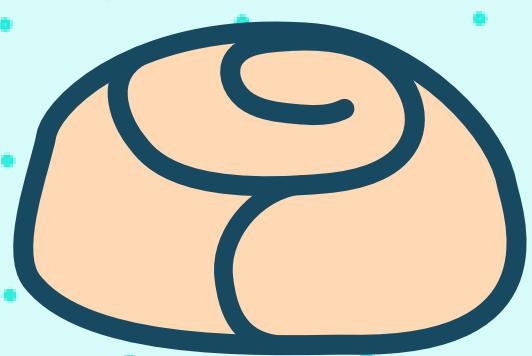
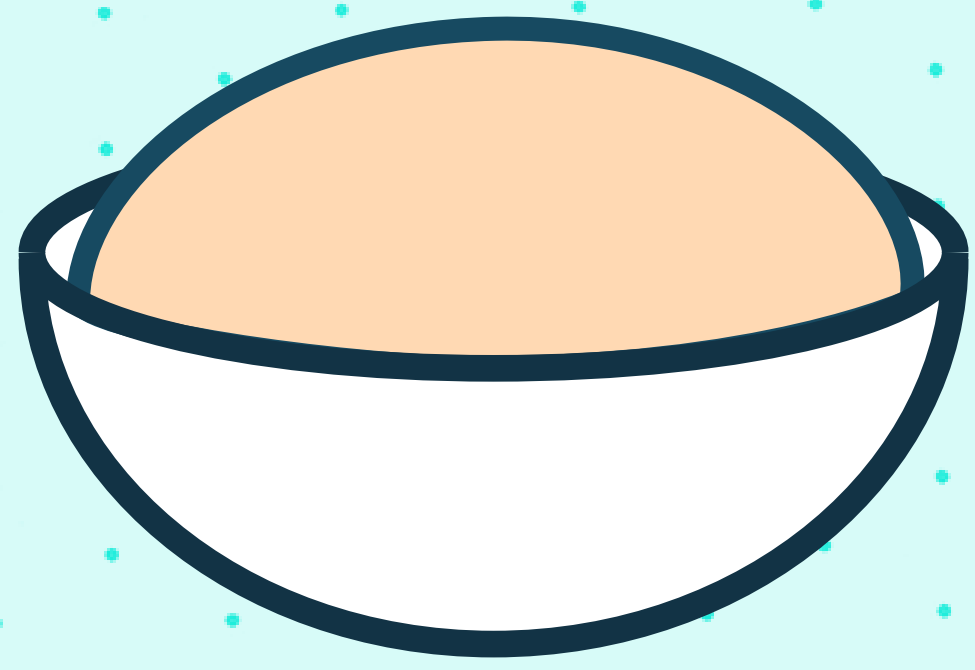
1 tsp. baking powder
gluten-free

1 tsp. xanthan gum

¼ tsp. salt

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Gather all ingredients. Preheat the oven to 350 degrees F (175° C).
- 2** Mix peaches, sugar, flour, cinnamon, and nutmeg together in a bowl.
- 3** Pour into a 9x13-inch casserole dish and dab butter pieces over top.
- 4** To make the topping: Mix flour, sugar, soy milk, baking powder, xanthan gum, and salt together in a bowl. Sprinkle over peaches in the baking dish.
- 5** Bake in the preheated oven until fruit is bubbly and the top is golden brown, about 45 min.
- 6** Let cobbler cool before serving.



» This recipe reminds me of chilly childhood fall Saturdays, coming home from playing outdoors, into the warm sweet smell of freshly baked homemade cinnamon rolls. It's been a while since playing outdoors but this sweet treat doesn't get old. Yeast-dough is a bit sensitive, takes its time, likes a certain temperature and to be treated with care, but once it's risen and put in form, the filling can be individualized, to your personal likings. It doesn't have to be the traditional filling described in this recipe. Be creative: finely diced apples, blueberries, banana, peanutbutter, chocolate chips ... »

CINNAMON ROLLS

PREP: 20 min

RISE: 2h 15min

BAKE: 20–25 min

INGREDIENTS

DOUGH

500 g all-purpose flour

1 pack (7g) dry yeast

75 g sugar

1 pack vanilla sugar

1 pack vanilla pudding powder
(optional)

250 ml whole milk
(or milk substitute) (lukewarm)

1 large egg (room temperature)

100 g butter (softened)

1 pinch of salt

FILLING

50 g butter (softened)

Cinnamon (as per taste)

50 g sugar

Ground nuts
(Almonds, Hazlenuts, Walnuts ...
whatever you prefer)

1 egg yolk & some milk (~1 tbsp.)
(for glaze)

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Mix flour, yeast, sugar, pudding powder, vanilla sugar, salt.
- 2** Add softened butter, egg and lukewarm milk and knead for about 5–10 min. until dough comes together and pulls away from sides.
The consistency should be smooth and soft. If the dough seems too dry, add a bit more milk.
- 3** Transfer dough to a greased bowl. Cover with warm, moist towel; let the dough rise at room temperature for about 1½ hours or until it has doubled in size.
- 4** Sprinkle a surface with some flour. Transfer dough to floured surface. Use a rolling pin to roll the dough into a 2 cm thick rectangle.
- 5** Spread butter over dough with a spatula and sprinkle sugar, cinnamon and nuts in an even layer.
- 6** Starting with one of the long ends, tightly roll dough up to form a log. Cut into even-sized pieces (around 2–3 cm/1 inch).
Cover with a towel; let rise an additional 45 min. Mix egg yolk with some milk, and glaze the rolls.
- 7** Meanwhile, preheat oven to 175°C/350°.
- 8** Bake 20–25 min. or until tops are lightly golden brown.

› I believe these are by my great great grandmother! So usually a well kept family secret ;) ‹



CINNAMON STAR COOKIES

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Beat egg whites until stiff. Gradually add salt, powdered sugar, and lemon juice while stirring.
- 2** Set aside 6 tablespoons of the mixture in the refrigerator.
- 3** Roll out dough on foil and cut out stars.
- 4** Preheat oven to 160°C and bake cookies for approximately 20–25 min.
- 5** Let stars cool, brush with the reserved mixture, and then let them dry.

INGREDIENTS

3 egg whites

1 pinch of salt

300 g powdered sugar

2–3 tbsp. lemon juice

500 g ground almonds

2 tbsp. cinnamon

LINZER COOKIES/JAM-FILLED SANDWICH COOKIES

PREP: 25 min

REST: 60 min

BAKE: 20 min

INGREDIENTS

550 g butter

250 g ground hazelnuts

360 g sugar

700 g flour

Red currant jelly

Powdered sugar

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Mix all ingredients together. Let rest for at least one hour.
- 2** Cut out round cookies, and for every second cookie, cut out a hole in the middle.
- 3** Cover work surface with parchment paper and roll pin with foil (wrapped around).
- 4** Preheat oven to 160°C and bake cookies light yellow (approximately 20 min.).
- 5** Spread warm cookies with red currant jelly and sandwich together. Sprinkle with pink sugar glaze (2 tablespoons red currant juice and powdered sugar) and colored sprinkles, or dust with powdered sugar.

NOTES:

These are traditional German/Austrian Christmas cookies. The cookies with holes become the tops, showing the jam through the center.

CHRISTMAS STOLLEN

PREP: 24h

BAKE: 40 min

INGREDIENTS

1250 g flour

250 g sugar

375 g butter

375 g chopped almonds

150 g candied lemon peel
(Zitronat)

375 g sultanas (raisins)

Grated zest of 1 lemon

100 g yeast

375 ml milk

Rum

150 g melted butter
(for brushing)

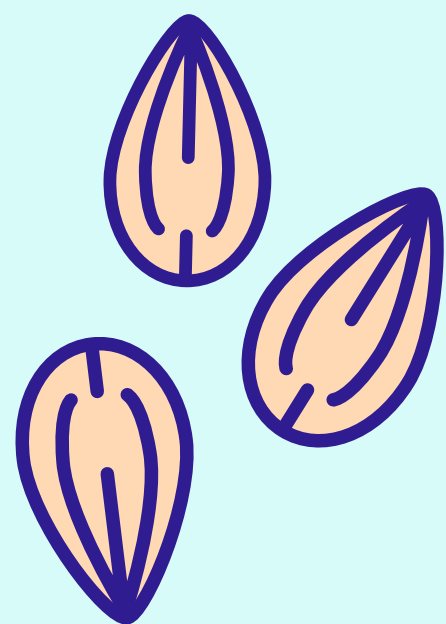
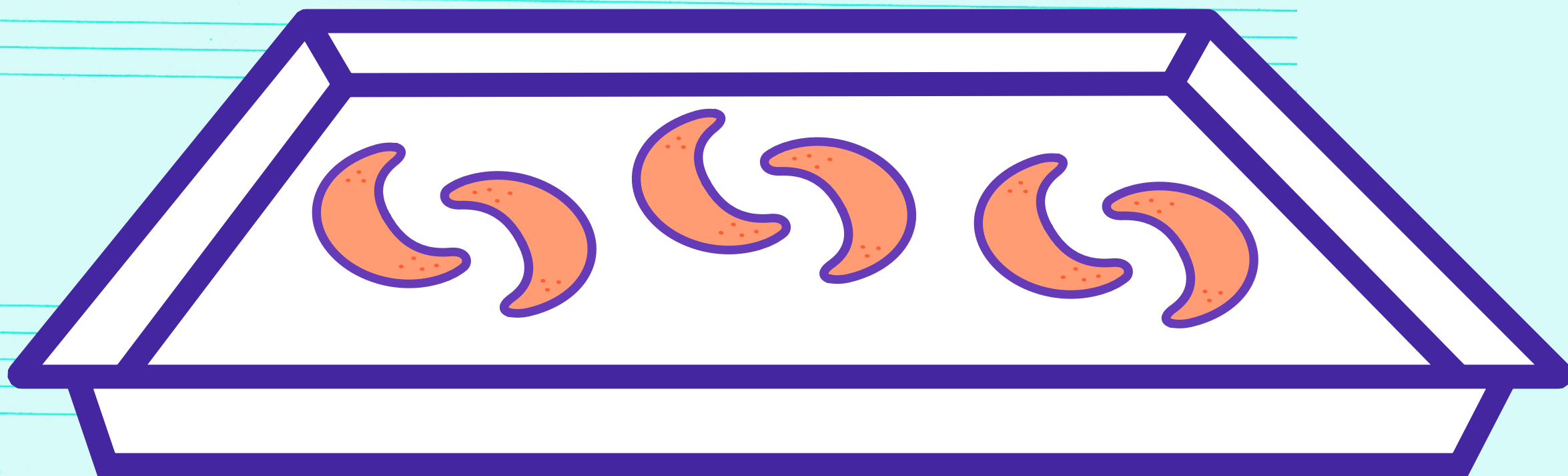
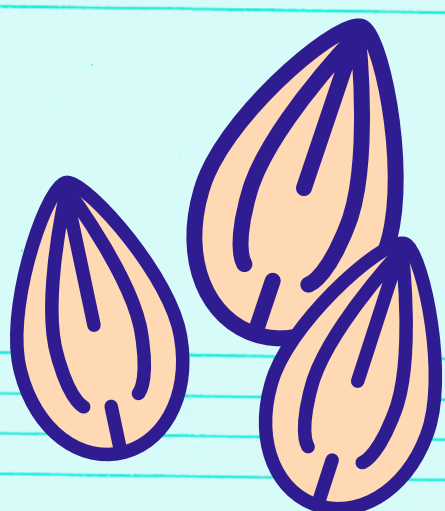
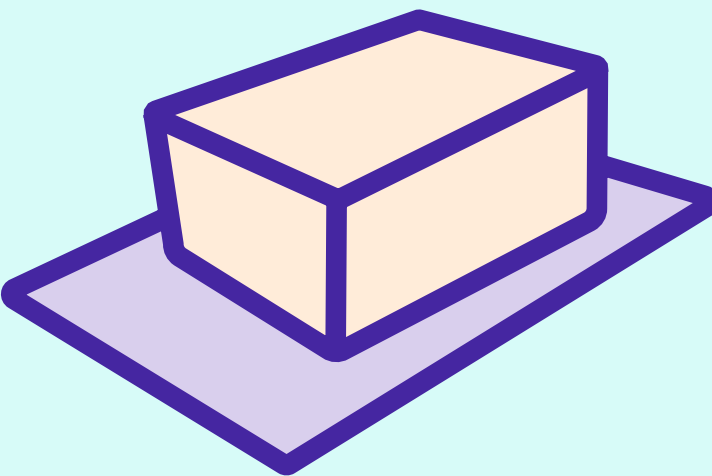
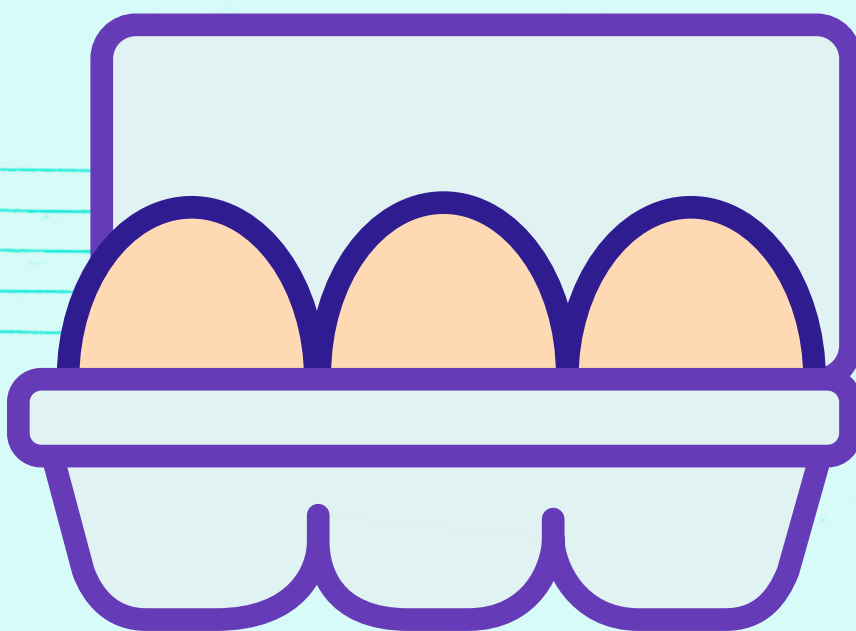
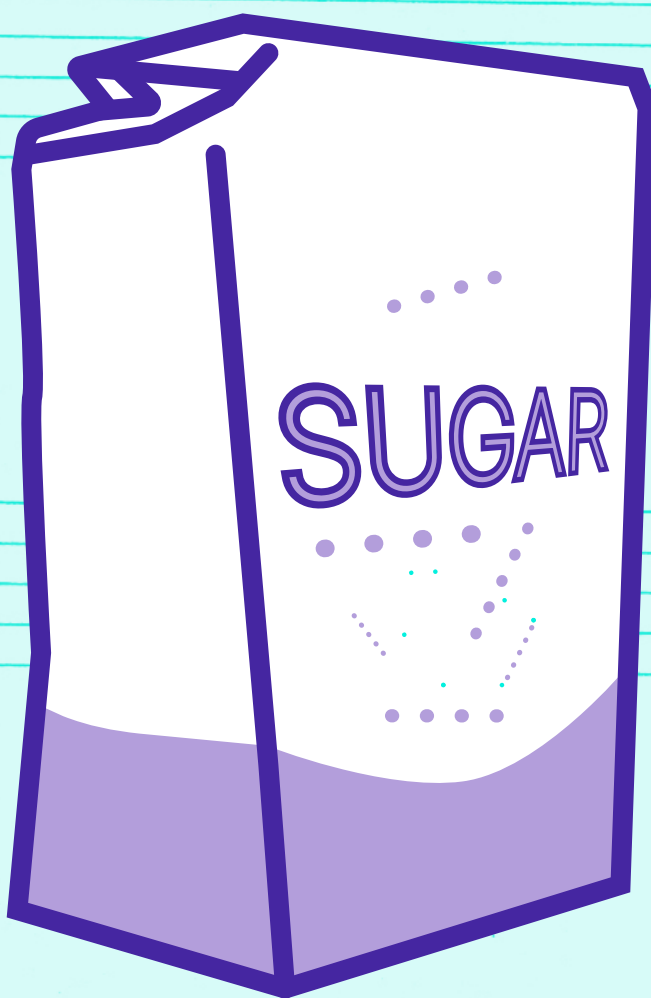
Powdered sugar

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Mix raisins with a portion of the sugar and sprinkle generously with rum. Let steep (one day in advance).
- 2** Make a pre-dough from the crumbled yeast, remaining sugar, and milk. Let rise at about 37°C for approximately ½ hour.
- 3** Mix the remaining ingredients (except melted butter and powdered sugar) and add to the pre-dough. Knead everything well and let the dough rise for another ½ hour.
- 4** Form 3 stollen loaves.
- 5** Preheat convection oven to 170°C and bake the stollen for 30 min. Turn off the oven and leave the stollen in the oven for another 10 min. (the stollen should still be slightly moist inside as it will continue to dry).
- 6** Brush the still-warm stollen with melted butter and dust with powdered sugar after cooling.
- 7** Wrap well in aluminum foil.



I came to Berlin in 2010 and these biscuits quickly became the taste of Christmas for me. I used to take boxes of Vanillekipferl home to England for my parents, and now I bake them each year with my children. It's one of those recipes that marks the beginning of the season for us—messy hands, clouds of icing sugar, and the smell of butter and vanilla filling the kitchen.



VANILLA CRESCENT COOKIES

PREP: 15 min

BAKE: 10–12 min

SERVINGS: 30–40

INGREDIENTS

280 g flour

100 g ground almonds
(or hazelnuts)

70 g sugar

1 pinch salt

1 tsp vanilla sugar

200 g cold butter, cubed

2 egg yolks

FOR COATING

100 g icing sugar

2 tbsp vanilla sugar

TOOLS

Mixing bowl

Measuring scales

Baking tray

Parchment paper

Small whisk or spoon

Cooling rack

Sieve (for icing sugar)

INSTRUCTIONS

- 1** Mix flour, ground nuts, sugar, vanilla sugar, and salt in a bowl.
- 2** Add the cold butter and egg yolks, then knead quickly into a smooth dough. Wrap and chill for 30 min.
- 3** Preheat the oven to 175 °C (top/bottom heat).
- 4** Roll small portions of dough into thin logs and shape into crescents.
- 5** Place them onto a baking tray lined with parchment and bake for 10–12 min. until just lightly golden at the edges.
- 6** While still warm, carefully toss the kipferl in the icing sugar + vanilla sugar mixture.
- 7** Let them cool fully so they become perfectly crumbly.



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